

Book Two

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Life in Sodom continued at a bustling pace after the fertility festival, as it had been explained to Edith. The motherly Canaan dog padded through the narrow streets at a brisk pace, carrying a large, clay pot in her arms. The muddy orange pot was taller than it was wide and entirely undecorated, though the aromas seeping forth turned the heads of many furs on the road, noses twitching. Regardless of her choice in wearing sandals, the canine was nude from muzzle to toe, enjoying the lick of warm air on her fur. Though she smiled amiably enough, Edith's mind was on other matters, besides keeping her footing in the too-loose sandals. A mother's concern was well-warranted when she had not set eyes upon her daughters or husband since embracing the ways of Sodom at the initial night of the festival.

But she had an idea of where she may begin her own search.

The wooden door of the inn was worn smooth by sand and Edit wondered how she could not have appreciated its aged beauty before. Light in colour, the wood could have mimicked her creamy underbelly if not for its scratchy tone and tinge of gold, which could have been from the sand. The canine could only speculate, not being privy to the skill and artistry of carpentry, despite having cousins involved in the trade. She cocked her head and studied the door some more; a single humped camel in the street behind gave her a querying look as he passed. How could she have missed the finer details in this door, she wondered to no one in particular, lips moving soundlessly. Her ears slanting back halfway to her skull. Perhaps she had been too busy staring at the heels of her husband's sandals to notice.

Enough time had been wasted, she decided, tapping the toe of one sandal in the dust. Raising a trembling paw, Edith tapped three times on the door.

It took several long, heart-pounding moments before she was able to discern movement on the other side of the door, some manner of shuffling and cloth rustling against fur. The door swung open as if the bottom edge was trapped in thick mud, even though it hardly scraped against the frame and moved without a sound. A slender Corsac fox stood within, a head taller than the canine and dressed simply in a loose, tan tunic. He could almost have been the spitting image of the little handmaid Edith had spied upon her earlier visit, but Edith thought it churlish to enquire as to any relationship between them. The Corsac fox licked his lips but made no comment on Edith's appearance. Suddenly tongue-tied, Edith looked between the fox and the interior of the inn, a blush creeping up her neck.

"Yes?" The innkeeper said mildly when she did not speak, leaning forward into the street. "Is there a matter I may help you with? I'm afraid there are currently no rooms available, although a lady as divine as yourself may find a partner willing to share."

Edith barked sharply, startled into sudden mirth. The fox hesitated for a moment as if considering his reaction before permitting a small smile on to his muzzle that brightened his whole demeanour. He seemed so serious when he did not smile, Edith noted even as her body rumbled with suppressed amusement, chuckling to herself for longer than was strictly polite. Once, such a comment would have embarrassed her and now it gave her a rush of power.

“I apologise for my behaviour,” she said at last when her chuckles died down. “It would be too much to explain in full but your comment amused me. I do not mean to be rude.”

She nodded and smiled gently, keeping her teeth covered to show no sign of threat.

“I am looking for my husband and daughters,” she continued, ignoring the slight catch in her own voice as she stated it aloud. “They last stayed here, I with them. It was Raguel, I believe, who arranged their lodging with you?”

Her tone betrayed a question as she did not truly know if Raguel had had any liaison with the innkeeper at all but it was a fair bet when all was said and done. The fox’ expression gave away little, though his ears pricked noticeably at the name. A light sigh escaped his delicate muzzle.

“I’m unsure of how much help I will be to you.” He spread his paws wide. “Of course, Raguel was a guest here and I remember him well. However, he has already left.”

Edith’s heart seemed to jump in her chest and sink somewhere in the region of her sandaled hind paws.

“Please,” she caught his sleeve as he made to turn. “You are the only assistance I may have if Raguel is indeed gone. All I want is to find my husband and daughters again – nothing else. Do not fear any trouble from me unless you are secluding them within.”

She attempted a small smile alongside her half-hearted jest, tail lifting with the semblance of her mood. The innkeeper did not need to know that she would have some choice actions for him if he was truly hiding her family from her, or at least so she told herself. The Corsac fox shook his head and tucked his tail between his legs. Despite his resemblance to the handmaid, Edith noted that he was considerably less...fluffy? Was that a way in which one could describe a male fur? She suppressed a deluded giggle.

Thankfully unaware of her observation, the fox scratched his chin, visibly considering her words.

“Please, do come in.” He stepped back at long last to allow her entry. “I am afraid that I only have a short time to spare, but I will do all I can. Perhaps there is some information I may impart to further your search.”

Breathing a sigh of relief, Edith padded inside before he had the chance to change his mind, fearing that she would be out on the street in the next moment, no further along her search than she had been the previous day. The fox gestured that she should follow and the canine trotted close upon his heels into the guest room Raguel had introduced them to only a few suns ago. How many suns had it been? Seven? Ten? More? She had lost count. It could have only been yesterday for all the concept Edith had of time.

She took the offered cushion with a sigh of relief, sinking into the plush surface and kicking each sandal gently to the side in turn. Before she had breath to ask for water to wash her hind paws, a petite Corsac fox of a darker shade folded sensuously to his knees at her side. Edith studied him from below her lashes, taking note of the faint blush colouring the tips of his ears. He wore a simple loincloth tucked around his waist that looked as if one tug would send

it tumbling about his ankles. Quickly and efficiently, the little fox dipped each of Edith's hind paws into a shallow bowl of water, scrubbing the dirt from them with the use of his own paws. When done, he rested both of her hind paws on a soft, clean cloth and lowered his head so that his chin touched his chest, sliding his gaze away from the canine's every time she sought it out. She shook her head as he rose and walked away, tail flattened as much as possible over his small rump; Edith's stare lingered until the innkeeper cleared his throat politely. Looking between the younger fox and the innkeeper, Edith tilted her muzzle and considered.

"My nephew." The innkeeper answered her unspoken question, waving the fox away with a smile that brought warmth to his eyes. "I had need of another around here since Esther disappeared."

The innkeeper frowned.

"I have been rude. I know your name from your residence here but you do not know mine." He inclined his muzzle gracefully. "My name is Malachi and, as you are aware, I take care of the inn. It is a humble business but one that I take delight in holding."

"For the time that I was here, I found the room of great comfort," Edith smiled. "It is a pleasant abode."

Though no more than acceptance of her compliment and statement was required, Malachi fell silent, stroking the back of one paw with the fingertips of the other. He dropped to one of the free cushions a comfortable distance from Edith with a quiet grunt of satisfaction, clearly eager to take the strain of the day off his hind paws. Seconds stretched out like minutes and Edith wondered if her nakedness made him feel uncomfortable as he was far more modestly clothed and evidently preferred those in his employ to be similar if 'Esther' and his nephew where anything to judge by. Ruffling up the fur on the back of his neck, Malachi cleared his throat and gestured at the vase that the dog still cradled preciously.

"What have you there?"

Thankful for the break in quiet, Edith was eager to tell.

"A gift for the innkeeper where I am residing until my family returns." Edith lifted the . "I'm told herbs and spices are most desirable within Sodom's walls. I hope it sweetens my liege some." She hesitated. "I may be overstaying my welcome."

"Why would you overstay your welcome?"

"I have no currency to pay for my stay," she confessed. "It is my friends in the city who are ensuring that I am not sent away, though I am able to stay with some of them if so required. Things will be easier once my family is found."

"I understand your concern for your family," Malachi's eyes grew dark, the pupils dilated. "I did mention in passing... My handmaid has disappeared. I cannot be entirely certain but it is most unlike her to run away, she was very happy here. This is one of the few places in which she is...safe."

“What is it you’re trying to say?” Edith shook her head, sliding her gaze to the left as she thought hard. “Lots has been going on in the city. Don’t you think she’s just joined in with the festivities and gotten caught up? A young fox like her should have plenty of admirers.”

“Esther did not engage in that manner of being,” Malachi said firmly. “She is not quite what she seems to be. I do not mean to question you but, knowing that it is very likely that she is with your husband and daughters from when she disappeared... Edith, can I trust you?”

“With your life.”

“I hope that it would never come to that,” he found some humour in the moment. “Esther is, in less serious terms, my cousin. In more serious terms, she is,” he swallowed, “physically a male.”

Edith blinked.

“How is that possible?” Her jaw worked, struggling to form words that would not come. “She looks... No, she is female!”

“I assure you that she is naturally a male,” Malachi corrected firmly. “She identifies as female and that is how I address her as my cousin. She takes certain herbs – something beyond my interest – to maintain her breasts. She is one who is not the gender she was born with.”

Sitting back on her rump – when had she leaned forward? – Edith fought against her natural instinct to reject this information. She had not heard of such a thing where she had come from. Then again, she had never contemplated enjoying sexual activity either. Was it wrong for one to be another gender? How could Esther be a female if she had male genitals? The canine frowned and rubbed her head, warding off the brewing headache. Of course, there could not be anything wrong with it; Esther had not hurt anyone with her choice and had not forced it on others from what Malachi had told her. Malachi allowed Edith time to absorb what he had told her but even he grew impatient: time was short.

“Whereas her lifestyle and chosen sex is nothing to be ashamed of or something frowned upon in Sodom, it is rare and Esther was not confident enough to proclaim it publicly. Why should she?” Malachi tilted his chin up. “She is who she is and that is no concern of anyone else’s.”

“No, of course it isn’t,” Edith bobbed her muzzle twice quickly. “It’s just...well...different. She must have found it difficult to adjust or even come to the conclusion that she is, um, not male. How does she know that?”

The fox sighed and brushed his ears back with one paw, smoothing the fur down flat in the correct direction. He was always fussing with his fur in one form or another and Edith’s paw twitched; she ached to run her fingers through its silken softness herself. It was an uneasy thought and perhaps one that she was utilising to distract herself from the notion of a male becoming a female. She resettled herself upon the cushion and waited for the contemplative fox to speak, irritation at his slowness bubbling a breath below the surface of her composure. Maybe all the sex had gone to her head to leave her so easily frustrated: she could not tell. Releasing a sigh that carried the weight of a hundred worries, the fox spoke at last.

“Others may not be as accepting as you.” Malachi’s eyes darkened. “It’s a hard concept for even you to grasp, though I see you try.”

Edith flinched. Was it that obvious?

“Does it matter if others don’t accept her?” Edith licked her lips, struggling to recover. “As you said, it is her life and her decision. As long as she is happy, this is not a choice that harms others. Esther should be happy.”

Malachi’s short bark of laughter surprised her but there was no amusement in the sound. Almost pityingly, he shook his head at the older canine.

“And what of your husband?” Edith swore the fox half-rolled his eyes before catching himself on the edge of rudeness. “Do you believe he will not ‘mind’ my cousin’s unexpected gender if discovered? Will he let it pass by so smoothly?”

“Lot...” Edith paled, her whole body falling under a sudden chill. “If he finds out what Esther really is. Malachi, there’s no telling what he’ll do to her!”

“That is what I am afraid of.”

Malachi’s ears pricked stiffly, tail rigid at his rear. Every muscle in his body was locked in place, mind racing through every terrible possibility that presented itself to his frantic mind. *Calm, calm now.*

“This only makes it even more vital that I find my family soon,” Edith said quietly, the gravity of the situation sinking over her. “For the sake of my daughters and your cousin. Malachi, you have told me much in such a short time, but can you help me?”

“I may,” he dipped his muzzle. “Or if what I know of their direction is not enough to assist, I am tracking Esther through my contacts in the city. She was seen with your family on the second day of the festival. The trail dries up after they reached the city wall, however.”

Edith fought not to interrupt the silence that he once again drifted into, his gaze fixed somewhere in the distance above her head. She turned her head from side to side, wondering if he actually saw her sitting in front of him, yet bit her hard enough to spurn a bead of blood.

“I know little more than what I have already told you, Edith,” he said at last, rolling each word on his tongue as if he was choosing them with the utmost care. “I have searched and I am still searching. I see your fire and passion for your family. Perhaps you can help me.”

She swore she caught a flicker of sadness laced with desperation not dissimilar to hers in his eyes. The fox swallowed noisily and stroked his tail.

“Perhaps you may return my cousin to safety, to me.”

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Outside the walls of Sodom, Imran's search teams were far from idle in their quest for Edith's family. Unlike Edith and Malachi, however, they found themselves with a deal more success than the anxious family members. A small party of four consisting of an ibex, oryx, sand cat and striped hyena loped over the rough terrain, muscle rippling beneath thin coats of fur perfectly suited to the harsh climate. They fared better than the canines across the rough, sparsely decorated ground, keeping up a good pace and trusting their bare hind paws and hooves to find purchase even as pebbles and grain shifted beneath them. Wearing nothing but loincloths, light cloth packs were slung over their shoulders, seeming far too small to carry anything of sustenance. Nevertheless, their provisions and natural knowledge of the land had carried them far and safely in their search, each knowing that time was likely running out for the lost canines like sand trickling through an hourglass.

The sand cat crouched in the dust, tracing the outline of some scuffed earth. Unable to make out any clear paw prints – though they were certainly paw marks – he sighed heavily, his narrow chest expanding noticeably. A slender cat, he tilted gracefully to his left, maintaining his balance as he peered around a scrap of vegetation – a twisted, gnarled bush that had somehow managed to cling to life with so little water available. The scent of more than one fur hung over this spot as if they had returned to the same bush time and time again. Leaning forward precariously, he circled his fingers in the dirt, seeking out a scrap of moisture in the shade and lifted the damp digits to his muzzle. He sniffed twice and wrinkled his nose: someone had urinated there. Whether it was the family they hunted for or others, there were other furs close. He only prayed they were not those of uncouth persuasion who would as soon slit their throats as they would steal their provisions.

Quickly, they must move quickly.

It was the ibex who spotted the cave and called him over, bidding him to rejoin the main team. Light on his paws, he sprang to their sides, leaving a small cloud of dust in his wake. They conversed in low tones and advanced on the barely visible cave mouth set halfway up the slope. Placing each paw with great care, every muscle tightened in their bodies, each member of the party prepared to take flight if the cave boded ill, acutely aware of the danger. They had been unusually lucky thus far and it would be pure irony if they were to stumble into a band of raiders instead of the family they sought. The sand cat shivered, the rings on his tail dancing as the tremble traversed the length. As they approached, the heady aroma of musk and unkempt bodies emanated from the cave, growing increasingly stronger.

Holding his breath, the sand cat eased his muzzle around the edge of the cave wall, a few feet away from a lip that plummeted several feet straight down; it would not do to fall. He almost recoiled from the sight that awaited him within the cave – three canines sprawled amongst blankets and sleeping mats in great disarray, fur matted with all manner of sexual juices and sweat. There had been a creek nearby. When had been the last time they had bathed? Certain that the cave's occupants were of no threat – surely lolling in drunkenness if the dripping wine skins were to be believed – he gestured for his team to follow and entered the cave.

As soon as he set the first paw into the cave, a fourth fur that he had not initially accounted for shot to her feet and scrambled to the back of the cave. The fox trembled and pressed herself into the stone, hugging a bundle of cloth to her chest. Unaware of what he had stumbled into, the sand cat spread his paws as if to placate the fragile looking vixen.

“Easy now,” he said quietly, maintaining as low and soothing a tone as possible in his raspy voice. “I mean you no harm. Who are you?”

The Corsac fox stared wide eyed, clutching the blanket to her chest with shaking paws, but had no answer for him, so great was her fear. The sand cat scratched his tan head, puzzled, and flicked his tail. What had come over this vixen? They had heard nothing of a fox travelling with the canines, if the sleeping canines were indeed the ones they had been seeking. Perhaps they had tripped over an unsuspecting, unrelated group of travellers? But how many could be travelling in such an unforgiving land? He shook his head: he was over thinking the matter in the heat of the moment. Assuming for the time being that the vixen was embarrassed by her near-naked state – even if an unusual affliction for one of Sodom or the general locality – he kindly averted his eyes and turned his attention to the canines. The large male slumbered peacefully, a moderate snore rumbling from his throat with every sleeping breath, but the fuller figured female sat up, rubbing drowsiness from her eyes. Between the cat and the Canaan dog, however, was a sprawled out dog with a goofy smile perking at the corners of her lips. With one arm thrown back behind her head, the blankets twisted around her legs and she blinked up at the cat as if not truly seeing him.

“Are you Pheine?” He asked of the slenderer, nearest canine.

Though it was indeed Thamma stretched out on her back, she could make no sense of his words and merely smiled drunkenly, lips moving to form no sounds.

“I am Pheine,” the other canine proclaimed clearly, a hint of pride in the clarity of her words.

The sand cat’s heart thudded heavily in his chest and he shuddered as if he had been dunked in a trough of rarely cold water. Thankfully, in his state, he was not called upon to speak as the ibex’ shoulders slumped forward and he dropped his pack on the ground.

“Thank the stars!” The relief was palatable in the ibex’ tone as he swept an arm out to the side. “We’ve been searching for you for suns. How have you managed to survive so long?”

“We had our ways.” Pheine’s eyes gleamed in the dim light. “Perhaps it is now time to return to civilisation, however. Don’t you agree, sister?”

The sprawling canine at her side nodded slowly, tail sweeping back and forth across the cave floor in a faint wag that betrayed a deep sense of content. Feeling as if he was missing something, the sand cat traced his mind back through recent events, the sights and scents he had catalogued so meticulously in his search and approach to their hiding place. The urination by the bush, the sense of ill-kempt the females radiated and the musky aroma of sex leading up to the cave. It took his mind a moment longer than he was proud of to catch up.

And then the ibex fell as still as a statue, even his slender tail resting quietly under his loincloth. The hyena cursed under his breath and took half a step forward, only halted by the oryx’ paw upon his forearm. Even the sand cat, so used to dealing with all situations under the sun had hoped never to come across such a situation. It was abhorrent, if what he suspected. Futilely, he scanned the cave for other occupants, nose sifting through the scents but there had clearly been no others in the cave bar those already accounted for. If there had been a male other than the sleeping fur that could *only* be their father from appearance and

age, things would have been very different. But this...this was wrong. Tearing his eyes away from Thamma's rounded belly, he swallowed hard.

Imran had said nothing about the daughters being pregnant.

Their eyes turned in unison to Lot and then back again to the smiling, oblivious female furs. The larger one, identified as Pheine, yawned lazily and burped.

"Wait...are you..." The ibex fumbled over his words. "You are Edith's daughters?"

"Yes, we are," Pheine confirmed, rubbing her abdomen in lazy circles. "Are you not looking for us? You knew my name."

"We were..." The ibex rubbed his shoulder, eyes dark with suppressed emotion. "We were not expecting to find you with litters."

Pheine giggled musically, the wine making her clap one paw over her lips like a canine of younger, more innocent years.

"Yes!" She beamed. "Isn't it wonderful?"

"And your sister?" The hyena spoke up. "Is she with pup too? What of the vixen? Are you injured in any way?"

Pheine tilted her head to one side, the very picture of a confused dog.

"No, no one here is hurt," she said. "Thamma has a litter too but I'm sure mine will be born before hers. Esther... Esther doesn't seem to be pregnant." The canine looked down at the ground. "It's unfortunate."

Shaking lightly, the striped hyena let a snarl rip from his throat, loud enough to make every conscious fur in the cave jump, startled. He strode up to the fat, sleeping male with a short, choppy stride and shook his shoulder roughly. The older dog grumbled in his sleep and made as if to roll over.

"Up," the hyena growled curtly, sparing the old dog no pleasantries.

Lot mumbled something incomprehensible, eyelids fluttering. Several skins of wine lay within reach, all empty, though it seemed as if the supply was at last running low. Pushing the dog with one hind paw, the hyena prodded the sleeper, thinking that that much of a rude awakening would be enough to persuade him into waking. When the dog did not rise, the hyena jerked angrily, grabbing him by the bicep.

"I said *up*."

Showing admirable strength for his comparably light physique, the hyena hauled the dog bodily to his feet, holding him upright by his shoulders. The canine's belly bulged and the hyena wrinkled his muzzle in distaste, though was glad to have something to focus on besides the condition of the old bastard's daughters. How could he have done such a thing?

Tightening his grip, the hyena shoved Lot away once the canine had enough sense to find his own balance in waking, too disgusted to even touch the male.

“What’s going on?” Lot mumbled, the first comprehensible words that he had been able to speak in a long time, as he swayed like the drunkard he was. “Who...who are you?”

The hyena chose not to answer and his companions were hardly disposed to explain. The dog knew what he had done – why should they waste words on him? Grunting, the hyena narrowed his eyes and turned Lot towards the cave entrance and bright sunlight, deliberately away from his daughters and the cowering vixen.

“You’re returning with us,” the hyena said simply, divulging no more information as that drop of anger spilled forth: he should have kept his muzzle shut.

“Returning where?” Lot latched on to the information.

“Sodom.”

“Sodom?” Lot blinked stupidly. “Why would I wish to return to that place of sinners? Have your Sodom and stay there. I’m returning to my homeland. With my daughters.”

The hyena’s jaw fell slack and he worked it in an effort to hold back his anger. *Sinners?* Was the dog dense as well as a law breaker? Dense enough to abuse his daughters so, that much was certain. In the background, he was dimly aware of Pheine’s protests but the ibex was with her, he was helping her – she would be well now that they had her in their care. The hyena shook his head and flung his paws in the air, meeting the sand cat’s gaze. *You deal with him.* The sand cat sighed heavily and composed himself.

“You’re *returning* with us,” the feline ground his teeth together, exercising every iota of restraint he possessed. “Do not argue. Do not fight us. You await trial in Sodom.”

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The lack of news drove Edith to pacing her quarters. She suppressed her growls with a great deal of frustration, throat rumbling lightly as they fought to break loose, to give voice to her fears. No longer housed in the inn, she strode past a luxurious sleeping mat piled high with blankets woven in the most exquisite fabrics; regardless of their thinness, they kept out the night chill beautifully if there was no partner there to warm her bed. She often had another fur in her bed. Since that first night in Sodom, her body had become demanding to the point of sexual exhaustion, collapsing into the mound of mats and blankets with nothing less than satisfied groans. There was that slight problem with her legs not working properly the next day, however, Edith recalled with a slight smile gracing her lips. The sex was good, she could not deny, but it was a distraction from what really encompassed her thoughts, every waking moment consumed by her family. Sighing heavily, she reached the far end of the room and turned on her heel to continue her cycling of pacing. There had only been one positive development in recent days and it was one that Edith was admittedly thankful for.

“Edith, stop pacing.”

When had she crept up on her? Her sister's tone was threaded with exasperation even as she tried to display compassion in the only way she knew how. Depositing the basket of fruit inside the entrance, Ansha confidently stepped forward to envelope her sister in a tight hug, drawing her close into her embrace. Edith stiffened and exhaled slowly, ordering each muscle in her body to relax into the soothing hold, though she felt nothing but comforted. Where was her family? She could not consider the worst case scenario in waking hours, nightmares simply fluttering through her unconsciousness like bats. Sensing Edith's resistance, Ansha insistently nuzzled closer, resting her muzzle on top of the canine's shoulder. Edith squirmed: she did not believe she would ever become used to her sister's naked body pressed up against her.

"I brought you a distraction," Ansha said with a wicked glint in her eye as she finally released her sister from her hug.

Edith shook her head. It likely went without saying that this was not the Ansha she remembered, this confident, bouncing canine who was quick to smile. Having spent some time in Sodom without the grasp of Raguel at her heels, the Canaan dog had changed so that she was almost unrecognisable. Rather than being a change that rendered the fur in question irrevocably different, however, Ansha could only be described as having blossomed, fully taking herself in paw for the first time in her life. Laughing, smiling and tossing quips in all directions, Ansha the most cheerful and bubbly she had ever been. And, if the noise emanating from her chambers was any indication, she did not lack for sexual partners.

Edith shook herself, snapping out of her musing with a guilty flush. Ansha awaited her answer.

"A distraction is not what I need." Edith looked away. "I need information. We've heard nothing –"

"Nothing is all you can expect to hear until Lot, Pheine and Thamma turn up outside," Ansha said firmly, pressing a finger to Edith's lips. "How can the search teams get word to you unless they return to Sodom? They will not return without some manner of news, therefore they are still seeking out your family."

"I want my family here."

Ansha's expression softened.

"I know you do," she murmured, cupping Edith's cheek in her paw. "But worrying will do you no good at all. Lot is capable, if...well...you know my thoughts on that dog. They are *safe*, that is what I am trying to tell you."

"In the meantime," she continued without allowing Edith time to reply. "I want to show you what I bought!"

Sighing, Edit folded to the sleeping mats, choosing a plump cushion for her seat. It was not usual to seat oneself in the bed chambers but she did not feel like moving, tiredness reverberating through her muscles. She may as well have aged ten years with how easily she tired these days.

Ignoring her sister's lethargy – she had something to perk Edith up anyway – Ansha beckoned to another fur beyond the door. Edith sat up straight, expecting to be presented with someone quite important, and dropped her ears in surprise when only a slender, nude equine entered the room. The horse's nostrils flared and he lowered his head so far that his chin brushed his sleek, black chest, which shone with good health. The fact that he was naked was of no surprise to Edith but his general demeanour was confusing. Curious, Edith leaned forward, almost tipping off the cushion in her eagerness to get a better look at the horse who flicked his tail under her intrigued observation. Ansha beamed.

"He's my newest servant," Ansha stated proudly, though her voice remained low in tone. "A little jumpy still – he'll get used to it here soon enough. He'll have to. What do you think?"

"I was not away one acquired servants like a commodity," Edith commented dryly, looking over the stallion. "Don't you have servants already? Can you afford another?"

"Oh, Edith," Ansha rolled her eyes. "Don't be so judgemental. And he's not *really* a servant, not in that sense."

"Then what is he?" Edith coughed into her paw, addressing the horse instead. "Forgive me, I did not mean to be rude. Who are you and what position have you taken on here?"

The stallion shuffled his hooves and looked down.

"I am a slave," he said without any inflection. "My position is to do as Mistress Ansha bids me and those within her household."

Edith started, her eyes going wide. Why had Ansha suddenly decided to purchase a slave? Had she gone mad? Most slaves that she knew of worked in some kind of physical labour position and nothing Ansha possessed was in need of permanent work or labour. She cocked her head, one ear drooping towards the floor purely by the effect of gravity. The slave stood perfectly still, one ear pricked attentively towards Ansha as she smiled happily.

"Are you so surprised, sister?" Ansha bounced on the balls of her hind paws, thrilled at having caught her sister on the back paw. "Don't you like him? I thought of you when buying him."

"Slaves are no strangers to me," Edith murmured. "What on earth do you need one for? The two that I have seen here...?"

She tailed off the question, thinking of the slight maid and older cook that had flitted about quietly in the background during her stay. Quickly, Ansha shook her head and held up her paws.

"No, they are servants and paid for their services," she said. "You pay a fair bit more for a slave but the rewards are far greater."

"What rewards?"

"My dear, Edith, can you not discern for yourself?" Ansha giggled. "Slaves can be used for *anything*, not just cleaning or cooking. The things that the servants will not do, he can do."

It took Edith a few moments for her mind to catch up with what Ansha implied and, when she finally understood, the canine could not help but roll her eyes with a touch of melodrama. Edith huffed loudly, looking between the horse and her sister.

“Oh, Ansha.” Edith was surprised to find herself disapproving. “Do you not have enough males in your bed as it is? Willing ones at that! What need have you of a slave on top of every other you have?”

Ansha bristled, hackles rising slightly like those of a feral canine, falling prey to older instincts.

“You have not yet come to understand the pleasures one such being can bring,” she said stiffly. “Do not think to judge me, sister. Life is different than you are used to and you would do well to embrace it.”

“I’ll take heed of every part of Sodom life,” Edith countered, “but with wisdom and careful thought behind me. Our actions affect more than ourselves, if you care to remember, sister.”

Snorting, Ansha rolled her eyes and said no more. Edith thought how much Pheine and Thamma were like Ansha and her, striking a pang of longing into the pit of her belly. Oh, how she missed them. She brushed the fur flat on her legs where it had become ruffled and took use of the ‘distraction’ of the stallion, raking her gaze along his finely muscled legs. A hint of rump was visible and she traced a mental line across his gleaming coat to the plump, exposed sheath. There was no question as to *why* Ansha had chosen this male slave, if her quest was indeed to use him in the bedroom at least some of the time. Edith could not disagree with her choice in that aspect.

Ansha sighed and waved her paw as if to physically clear the air, turning her attention to the cause of their disturbance.

“Slave,” she addressed the horse who nodded his head to show he was listening. “Fetch us some wine. You will find Anya in the kitchen. She knows what I like.”

“Yes, Mistress,” he murmured, bowing as he turned and disappeared through the doorway as silently as he had arrived.

Walking from Edith’s designated quarters with a shrug of her shoulders, Ansha trusted that the other canine would follow her in due course. The reception room was far more comfortable and as luxurious without boasting the added edge of being *Edith’s* space. The canine exhaled heavily and flopped on to a recliner, propping her legs up with a light thud; she did not care how ungainly she was when there was no one around and, if truth be told, she was not the most graceful of furs at the best of times. But matters worried at the corners of her mind, demanding attention amidst the need for relaxation. She frowned, her brow creasing. It had been good of Imran to point her in the direction of the stallion slave, but how was she to get Edith involved when she was so...Edith? It was a dilemma indeed.

Edit appeared shortly after Ansha had settled with her lips pressed into a thin line. That was fine: Edith had often been annoyed at Ansha in past years. Settling on to the opposite recliner, the motherly dog sat upright with her back tense, eyes sliding towards the entranceway every

other second as if she was waiting for someone to enter. The horse entered from the other doorway and was barely noticed, balancing a tray bearing a tall pot of wine and two drinking vessels. He looked down at the tray and bit his lower lip, arms trembling faintly. Ansha suppressed a smile, looking him over fondly. Young, inexperienced and virile: she had a lot to teach this one.

Edith's distraction was not easily kept at bay and it was not the pleasant distraction that Ansha had planned for her. How could she so easily ignore the horse when he stood between them while they sipped wine? It was a strong liquor that sent Ansha's senses spinning pleasantly, the wine sweet upon her tongue. Drinking sparingly, Edith drifted into contemplative silence that Ansha could not abide at the best of times. She would do no good to herself brooding! Reclining into a more comfortable position, Edith stared into her cup of wine as if to see through the depths of ruby liquid.

Shifting his weight from hoof to hoof, the horse flicked his tail but otherwise remained perfectly silent, as was correct for one of his station under Ansha's preferences. Ansha tilted her head and surveyed him from below lowered eyelashes, wondering how far she could push matters. Though the horse had no say in it, she knew exactly what Edith was like with a little wine these days, more susceptible and open to suggestion by far. Pricking her ears, Ansha concocted a plan to get the canine to loosen up, a lazy grin softening the appearance of her narrow muzzle. Yes, that was it. It was simply because Edith did not understand that she opposed the idea so, no matter how polite she was. She could show her the benefits of such a slave in a far more physical and visual way – besides serving such fine wine. And being exceptionally easy on the eyes, a contestant for even Imran's defined masculinity.

Focus, she had to focus. Losing track of her train of thought was all too easy for the canine at times. The horse was close enough, standing within arm's reach, and the dog casually reached out to caress his thigh, feeling the smooth line of muscle beneath his short coat. He really was in excellent condition, sold exactly as marketed. The horse tensed but made no other motion bar the restless swishing of his tail. Ansha caught Edith sneaking a look from the corner of her eye and, emboldened, slid her paw up the horse's inner thigh to his heavy orbs to squeeze gently. Oh, yes, he would do *very* nicely! Groping her new slave's sheath lewdly, the canine drew her fingers along the soft flesh, feeling her prize stir within. Edith's head jerked up and her eyes widened shockingly.

"Ansha?" She snapped her slack jaw shut swiftly. "What are you doing?"

"There's nothing wrong with your eyes, sister."

That was the best answer she was going to give Edith. Ansha's voice took on a sultry lilt and the horse nickered softly, pink and black cock dropping from its sheath with an eagerness drawn from her skilled paw. Turning his head bashfully away, the equine nickered under his breath, tail swishing like a pendulum in time with Ansha's wicked strokes.

"Poor pony," she crooned. "Where were you heading tomorrow, Edith? It seems to have slipped my mind."

Edith raised an incredulous eyebrow, determined to keep her jaw firmly shut this time.

"You surely cannot wish to discuss this now?"

Her sister must have been, well, barking mad.

“Why not?” Ansha feigned innocence. “I do as I wish in my quarters and this abode belongs to me.”

“By all means, enjoy your new slave,” Edith surprised herself with a low chuckle. “Just unsure whether I can maintain a sensible conversation while you tease him so.”

“Isn’t it perfect though?” Ansha smiled happily, paw ever in motion as the horse stomped a hoof. “He’s a *virgin*, saved especially for me!”

Her tail wagged, brushing over the cushions, though the stallion did not notice her happiness or words. His head lolled back as Ansha slipped her paw between his thighs, pushing the defined muscle apart with no more than her fingertips, evidencing her control with the smallest of actions. A bead of pre cum clung to the head of his cock, threatening to drop to the floor until Ansha’s roaming paw scooped it up, smearing the pearly moisture across her own palm. The sultry canine raised her paw to her muzzle slowly, lapping up the salty treat while keeping eye contact with the equine, whose chest heaved. Swallowing hard, Edith strove to concentrate.

“It’s not often one considers a male’s virginity such a prize,” Edith murmured. “Why so valuable to you?”

“Mine was sold,” Ansha said bluntly. “I’m confident I’ll be a better mistress to this male than my husband was a ‘master’ to me in the bed chamber.”

“As good a reason as any,” Edith said so quietly that she doubted Ansha heard, though it was of little concern to the distracted dog.

Ansha wrapped her paw around the horse’s thigh – as much as she could – and drew him insistently closer, murmuring encouragement as her eyes danced. Steadily, her fingertips slid around his buttocks, finding a spot under his tail that made the horse stiffen, eyes shooting wide in the next heartbeat. Sitting up once more, Edith tried to subtly crane her neck, cursing how the horse’s tail blocked her view of Ansha’s paw, curiosity getting the best of her. Ansha smirked deviously and pressed her paw closer to the horse in such a way that Edith could neither see nor discern what was happening, only the slave’s reactions. The equine’s breath caught in his throat and he pinned his ears back, muscles twitching beneath his fine coat.

“You did not answer my question, sister,” Ansha gently drew Edith’s attention back to her, unable to keep the smile from her muzzle.

“Still?” Edith sighed. “You are implausible. What else do you expect me to be doing, Ansha? Looking for my family, as always.”

Ansha knew Edith too well to take her sister’s snap to heart. It was also difficult to be annoyed with a throbbing cock in one’s paw.

“No need for the tone,” Ansha bit back a chuckle and blew the horse a kiss as he gasped under her paw. “Anyone would think you were frustrated.”

Missing the hint, Edith bobbed her muzzle in full agreement, running her paw roughly through her hair.

“I am!” She said a little too loudly. “What am I expected to do, Ansha? It’s insanity! I’m going insane. Every day, I do the same and I can do none other than the same, because I *must* find my family. There is nothing else I can do, nothing else I can think of and nothing else I can dream of when I close my eyes.”

Edith paused, eyes downcast as she pretended to study something in the patterns of her fur. Startled by the outburst, Ansha hesitated in her ministrations, much to the stallion’s temporary relief.

“I don’t even sleep well anymore, Ansha,” she continued quietly. “If not for all the herbal mixtures here – Sodom is nothing but an expert in the luxurious, I do concur – you would not be able to look at me for how dreadful I would appear. And I am not the most vain of canines, you should know.”

Lowering her muzzle, Edith slouched on the recliner, stretching out on her side with her head on her folded arms. Her body shook with a suppressed sob and she tucked her tail between her legs, subconsciously disliking the thought of having her privates on display to anyone while she trembled with tears she refused to give life to. Regardless of her distraction, Ansha leapt to her paws and darted to her sister’s side. She ignored the slave she left standing at her heels, unsure whether to turn, to stay, to leave or something entirely different, and dropped to her knees, putting herself on the same level as Edith. Sliding her arms about the other canine’s shoulders, Ansha pressed herself close, wishing belatedly that there was more she could do. If only she could deliver Edith’s family into her paws, even that abomination Lot. Perhaps the horse had been a bad idea.

“You are doing all you can,” Ansha rubbed her sister’s shoulder soothingly, though the words seemed empty even to her. “We are all doing all we can. You cannot search every minute of every day. You said yourself that you are not looking after yourself.”

“Looking after *myself*? I should be out there looking for them,” Edith growled softly, shoulders slumping. “My daughters... What if something happens to them? I’ll never...”

She trailed off, leaving the worst unsaid, hanging in the air like a thundercloud. Helpless, Ansha patted Edith’s back, glancing from object to object within the room as if hoping for a sudden flash of inspiration that would fix everything. But that would never happen. In a last ditch attempt, her eyes alight on the horse and the canine sighed lightly, wondering. It could not hurt. It may even raise Edith out of her sadness.

“Edith, darling,” Ansha tightened her paw on the canine’s shoulder, sitting her up slowly. “I have a straight confession for you.”

“What’s that?” Edith blinked, moistening her lips with the tip of her tongue. “Why this? Why now?”

“It may be the best time,” Ansha bit her lip, sinking into a more comfortable crouch before Edith, her head lower than her sister’s. “Or maybe the worst. Please do not think badly of me, Edith, I know I am different but I care deeply for you. That should go without saying.”

“Ansha, I know,” Edith surprised herself by leaning forward, brushing her muzzle against Ansha’s in a sisterly kiss, enjoying the contact. “You don’t have to tell me that. We will always be sisters and I know you care. I care about you too. I’m glad to have you with me and you have been so kind.”

Ansha winced.

“Kind to a point,” she said. “I don’t want to make you disagree.”

“Why would I?”

“The slave?” Ansha jerked her head back over her shoulder in a needless gesture. “He...well... That bit’s not quite what I said.”

“Ansha, stop speaking in riddles,” Edith said with a heavy sigh: it was nothing she had not heard before, this evasiveness. “What do you mean? Straight and plainly, please.”

“I bought the slave for you!” Ansha blurted out, the words tumbling over one another in their rush to escape, to be said no matter what the cost.

Edith was quiet for several long moments, folding her paws in her lap and looking down. Unable to tell whether she was digesting the information or was upset, Ansha fidgeting, shifting her weight from one hind paw to the other, tail tucked in close. When Edith still said nothing, she could not find the willpower to remain silent, tension crackling in the air.

“We thought you needed some gentler attention.” Ansha’s bottom lip trembled anxiously. “I know you have company in your quarters but you cannot always get a male to do as you wish. I like these males in Sodom well enough, but a slave... They will do anything you wish, whether it be lapping your cunny for hours or giving you a sensitive, listening ear.”

Cupping her paw under Ansha’s muzzle, Edith silenced her with a touch, meeting her sister’s eyes with a note of caution.

“I appreciate the gesture,” she glanced at the horse who still stood with a hard, waiting cock. “But I’m not sure I can truly accept it. This is not my area of expertise and he is different from what I’m used to.”

“You don’t have to take him to bed with you, Edith.”

“And what if I’d want that?” Edith pressed her lips together.

“Then you would be more than welcome to,” Ansha tried for a smile, lips twitching up at the corners. “That’s what he’s here for. I am his owner but you should consider him yours for as long as you here. We can transfer ownership to you later if you find him useful.”

Shaking her head, Edith refused to speak, tapping the knuckles of one paw with the fingertips of the other. To Ansha's rear, the stallion shuffled around to face them directly, his head respectfully bowed while his nostrils flared, betraying his excitement if his hard length did not speak loudly enough. Against her will, Edith could not drag her eyes away, wanting to fall prey to the 'distraction' so pleasantly presented to her. Oblivious to this mental warring, Ansha twitched in the quiet, grabbing Edith's paws without any warning. The canine raised an eyebrow, looking down at her sister and finding she disliked the way her muzzle was higher. It felt inherently wrong but it was the wrong time for the observation.

"Want to try him out?" Ansha grimaced. "I know I speak coarsely of him, but he is a charmer, genuinely. I want to help him relax into himself as much as you."

"I can't just do that – here!" Edith rolled her eyes. "Honestly, Ansha."

"You didn't say no." The canine's eyes twinkled with life. "So that would be a yes to that question."

Edith's mouth twisted but she did not deny her sister's claim. She could not simply turn it down as much as she could not simply accept it either. It was a conundrum indeed, yet one that Ansha pursued relentlessly.

"I don't need a slave in my bed chambers," Edith said weakly after a longer than necessary pause. "I have others for that, kind males that I've found here."

Ansha tilted her head, leaning in close as if to share a personal secret with her sister.

"You're the one who brought up the bed chambers, dear," Ansha countered, taking her sister's paw. "Let me show you."

Edith protested faintly but even those murmurs of dissent became swiftly weaker as she was insistently drawn closer to the stallion. Her sister giggled lightly, all trace of her sombre mood vanished, and reached out to grasp the horse's tail, giving it a playful tug. His lips parted noiselessly and Edith felt his gaze upon her body, tracing every curve with an alluringly shy eagerness to his sidelong looks. Placing her paw under his muzzle, she boldly tilted his muzzle up and met his eyes with an awkward smile, wondering if she was stupidly to reintroduce herself in such a situation. Then again, none of the other males she had spent time with had minded fondling without express invitation.

Would it be so wrong?

Edith shook her head slowly, allowing her thoughts to drift until Ansha tapped her bare hind paw. But it was not something that Edith found she could rush into. She was acutely aware of every muscle in her body, her heart pumping blood, blood throbbing in her ears and the raking of each breath through her dry muzzle as she breathed. Every breath came harsher than the last and her bosom heaved as if she had exerted herself terribly, but at last she called upon her reserves of courage – would that she had something greater to use her courage for – and trailed her paw down from the horse's muzzle, feeling the definition in his chest. He shifted and she did not stop there, once she had begun, letting her paw fall lightly to his cock where it wrapped sensuously around the familiar-shaped shaft. The horse's member pulsed within her paw, seeming to grow as the canine squeezed gently, pumping the length with an easy,

skilled stroke. Blushing harder than ever, the stallion turned his muzzle away, letting his forelock flop into his eyes. Ansha caught the motion.

“So shy?” Ansha pressed her fingers over her lips to suppress her giggles from bursting forth. “You should be proud of what you have to show, my dear.”

Refusing to answer, the horse lowered his muzzle further, chin brushing his broad chest.

“Are you proud of what you have to show?” Ansha probed, gaze intense and demanding an answer.

“Yes, Mistress,” the equine nodded, crimson to the very tips of his ears. “I am proud of...it.”

“Then do not hide yourself from us.”

If possible, the horse turned a deeper shade of red, the flush creeping hotly down his neck. His tail twitched, flicking the strands against his legs, and Edith curiously explored his body with her paws, dropping to her knees to more easily fondle his balls and call forth needy nickers from his sweet lips. What would it be like to kiss those lips? The canine, rolled his nuts between her fingers, smiling at how his body shifted, arching towards her as if silently begging for more. He was a quiet one, that was for sure, biting down hard into his lower lip rather than vocalise his arousal. Perhaps he had been taught differently in early training, that he was to be as quiet as possible? Edith vowed to change that. She would make him moan and spurt. Despite Edith’s ministrations, the stallion still clamped his tail over his buttocks, keeping it pressed down as if it was the last covering he had left, even if his paws occasionally twitched towards his cock from time to time. He had some restraint at least, which pleased Ansha, but not enough. Frowning, Ansha tapped the horse on the nose, startling them both.

“Didn’t you hear me, slave?” Ansha winked, showing that her stern tone was merely for show. “Do not hide from us. Present yourself to my sister.”

The horse groaned lowly, obeying without conscious thought and dropping to his knees as Edith stood tall once more. He knelt with his legs apart, letting his balls swing gently between his thighs, and rested his paws palm up on each thigh. Keeping his arms relaxed and stance ready for instruction, he looked straight ahead of him and, completing the pose, raised his tail high, the long hair falling in a silky curtain. In this position, his rump was entirely exposed and he visibly struggled to hold it high, twitching the muscle at the base as his desire to conceal himself swelled. Unconsciously, Edith licked her lips – they had suddenly become dry – watching as the equine’s muscles tensed and relaxed, his fight to maintain position strangely beautiful. And she wanted him.

He must be the same age as Thamma, Edith thought through a lusty haze. Maybe she would like to meet him later.

It was a strange thought to have at the time and one that she would return to at another time. Almost tenderly, Edith caressed the horse’s muzzle, rubbing her fingertips in soothing circles until he leaned into her paw, momentarily distracted by her touch.

“I’ve heard what goes on in your bed chambers, dear.” Ansha decided Edith needed additional prompting. “Why don’t you see what that shaft feels like between your lips?” She smirked. “I don’t think he’s quite ready to mount or be mounted. I assure you that you’ll be the first when that time comes, however.”

She could have rolled her eyes or glared at Ansha, but Edith found the thought unusually appealing. It was as if she was watching the scene from another room, peering through the doorway and observing another fur that just like her doing things that she had never dreamt of. Stroking and teasing a slave! What would her old self have thought of her? Then again, it was not about the old and the new: it was about being who she really was. And she knew exactly how she wanted to proceed.

“Lay back,” Edith instructed the horse softly, the command feeling odd upon her tongue – it was a far cry from how she usually behaved and spoke.

It was just that easy. The horse immediately tipped back, rolling neatly on to his back and shifting so that he lay flat on the floor mats, ears pricked attentively. Instructions were something familiar to him and it was a simple matter for him to do exactly as he was told, thinking nothing more of the order. Edith followed with a throaty growl that sent a shiver through the equine’s body, resting her paws heavily on either side of his muzzle with her breasts swinging with every minute motion. So close to the equine, Edith sensed how his breath quickened with her closeness, a barely discernible sheen of sweat setting a gleam upon his coat. Regardless of his obedience, he still pressed his legs together shyly, hiding his balls between as his cock jutted up proudly, unable to be contained by any act of modesty.

“Spread your legs,” Edith murmured. “I don’t want you to hide from me. Keep them like that unless I say otherwise.”

The horse whined softly but did as he was ordered, spreading his legs until the near one bumped into Edith’s, allowing it to go no further. Thus freed, his grey-black balls hung heavily between his muscled thighs, two orbs that begged to be touched. Edith’s lips parted and she shook herself out of a brief stupor.

“Oh, that’s good,” Edith breathed, unable to tear her eyes away. “You look good enough to eat, boy.”

“Please don’t,” Ansha commented dryly, taking up post upon the nearest recliner, a cup of wine in her paw. “We wouldn’t want to come off as barbaric, darling.”

Edith wagged her tail, swinging a leg over the male’s body so that she knelt astride his chest, rump facing his muzzle. Glancing back over her shoulder, Edith winked at the horse, her fluffy tail bouncing as she met his startled gaze: he was amusing to tease. Had he ever had his muzzle so close to a female’s sex before? She knew nothing of his background or training and it was a great temptation for Edith to sit back and find out, but she had a bigger prize in mind. Taking his cock in one paw, she stroked the length slowly, drawing a sharp inhalation of breath from her victim; Ansha cocked her head like the curious canine that she was.

“I say nothing about him eating you, however,” Ansha quipped, lips twitching as Edith took up position.

Edith laughed, arching her back and dropping her muzzle to lap over the head of the equine's member.

"Just a show for you, darling," Edith winked flirtatiously. "Now let us see what this new slave of yours truly has on offer for us."

Sampling a new male was quickly becoming one of Edith's favourite pastimes – and she had many pastimes to choose from in her position. Holding the horse's shaft up with one paw, she kissed and licked down one side and then the other, marvelling at the size. How would he feel inside her? She couldn't wait to find out. His cock was very faintly marbled in such a way that one could only discern the pattern from very close quarters, which Edith was intimately privy too. Taking the thick, flat tip between her lips, she sucked experimentally, rewarded with an unwilling grunt of pleasure. The canine grinned: the poor thing was determined to remain composed even with his cock in her muzzle. How it would feel to 'break' him, to make him moan and buck and writhe in release. Closing her eyes, Edith dove down upon the horse's shaft, far enough that she gagged, the head pressing into the very back of her throat.

"How does he taste?"

Edith grunted in answer, tail wagging furiously. She deigned to pull back either to give herself respite or her sister an answer, instead rubbing her tongue along the top side of the horse's member. Her paws grasped what she was not able to taste and she squeezed the firm pole of flesh as the horse tensed beneath her. It was a great sense of power to sit over a male and have him exactly where she wanted him. With a flush of warmth racing through her veins, she *knew* she could tell him to do anything at all and it would be done, even with his shyness. He would *obey*. In front of her muzzle, the equine's tail swished constantly and she noted with added approval that he kept his legs in exactly the position he was asked, pulled back enough that he remained perfectly on display.

When had been the last time that the horse had had a good climax? Edith murred quietly, letting her lips circle his cock in a tight O-shape, sucking hard enough to make her cheeks hollow slightly. Digging his hoof-like fingertips into his leg, the horse tensed, a huff of hot breath escaping his nostrils in a rush as he snorted heavily. She growled dominantly, letting her teeth graze the shaft just enough for the horse to stiffen, anticipating pain, and relax again, though the edge of fear did nothing to diminish his rampant erection. She bobbed her muzzle slowly, sinking down lower each time she took the length in deep, relishing in the salty pre cum coating her tongue. Half-opening her eyes, Edith pushed her body forward, one paw cupping the stallion's balls and rolling them between her palm and fingers. From the corner of her eye, Edith caught motion and was dimly aware of Ansha masturbating to the sight of her sucking off the slave. The knowledge only turned her on more, pussy swollen and dripping with arousal.

As more heat brought a flush to the skin under her fur, Edith rumbled with growls she had not known resided in the pits of her belly. They seemed to rise from a primal place and every one rolling over the equine's length made his muscles stiffen – it became a game to catch him unawares. Slanting her ears to the side, Edith narrowed her line of vision, staring right down the thick shaft to his plump balls, paw creeping below them as the stallion's legs quivered. It was where Ansha's paw had been and Edith circled her fingertips around the horse's tight pucker with a shiver of devious excitement. Males liked to be touched there too, right? Scooping some stray pre cum on to her fingertips, she brought that paw back to the slave's

tail hole, easing a single finger inside with the slickness. With that, Edith heard a thump as the horse's head fell back to the floor and he breathed out a nicker. Suppressing a chuckle around the meat stretching her lips, Edith drove her finger in up to the knuckle, muzzle bobbing furiously as the horse twisted and groaned.

She recognised the signs of a male approaching orgasm as well as any other experienced female. A tremor reverberated down her spine, making her fur fluff up lightly from excitement. How much would he cum? She would soon find out. Panting, the slave screwed up his muzzle, fighting against his body to hold out a few seconds longer but respite was not to be had under Edith's demanding paws and lips. He came with a shuddering whinny, pulling his legs in closer to his body at an angle that should have been painful but the flexible equine somehow managed. Edith pulled her muzzle back just in time to receive the first spurt across the side of her muzzle, snaking her tongue out to taste the viscous, salty liquid that drooled over her lips. Caught in the throes of climax, the horse bucked his hips like a feral, each throbbing pulse of his shaft bringing forth a fresh rope of cum to paint the canine's muzzle, splashing across the cream and tan fur. He had plenty to spare and Edith could not bear to let it all go to waste, diving back down on to his cock with a grunt as the tip was forced into the back of her throat. She pressed her tongue to the underside of his hot length and murred as he gave more and more, feeding her more than enough for the lusty canine to gulp down, delighting in the lewd sound it produced.

The horse only had so much to give before he was, sadly, entirely spent. Collapsing to the ground, his shaking legs dropped with a loud 'clop' as each hoof touched down, shaking as if he had galloped across the desert and back again just prior. Edith rested the majority of her weight upon her arms, taking in short, sharp breaths as she struggled to regain her composure, if that was possible in such a compromising position. Eyes half-lidded, the horse groaned, treated to the unobstructed view of Edith's dripping pussy. He raised his muzzle halfway to her cunny before the lack of energy betrayed him, leaving him sprawled back on the ground, though his attempt was not missed by their aroused observer. Clearing her throat, Ansha abruptly reminded the gasping duo of her presence, paw still between her thighs and soaked in her own juices. There had been no reason for her to not enjoy the show, after all. The canine licked her damp paw and caught Edith's eye with a sly wink.

"Quite the virile one, is he not?" Ansha grinned. "But he's made a mess of you, sister."

Edith looked up in response, one eyebrow raised as she gently withdrew her finger from the horse's tail, seeing how the tight muscle clenched upon nothing in its absence.

"I think I am at least partly to blame for that," she answered with an uncharacteristically mischievous smile, lapping what cum she could from her muzzle. "You cannot place fault on him for it."

"I don't intend to," Ansha assured her. "But you are to clean my sister's muzzle with your tongue, slave. It's terrible manners to leave her in such a state."

Referring to Edith's unsatisfied arousal in turn, Ansha suppressed a wider smile, unwilling to give her sister cause to snap. Horniness did that to a fur, after all, and short tempers were common with any so frustrated. Surprising her with his instant obedience, the horse slid out from beneath Edith and crouched in front of her as she rocked back on to her knees and heels, smiling as she waited upon his attentions. Tenderly, he leaned forward, cupping her cheeks in

his large paws with fine, long fingers, and lapped the cum from her muzzle. He took great care to clean up every drop – perhaps disliking the thought of displeasing either of his mistresses – and did so without a single blush. Stroking Edith’s cheeks with the taste of his own cum strong within his muzzle, he sat back into a deep crouch, squatting with his legs spread apart, just as the ladies liked it.

Ansha took a deep, slow breath: the horse had surpassed her expectations by far. What a gem Imran had sent to her. She smiled warmly.

“My sweet ‘Zonah’,” Ansha reached over, running her fingers through the horse’s mane as if he was a pet sitting at her paws. “Do you like knowing that you are nothing more than a little whore, slave?”

The equine flushed heavily and shook his head, though his gaze was wrought with uncertainty. He was no Zonah! He was more than that, he could do more. Edith would have raised an eyebrow at the name if she was not too busy brushing the fur on her muzzle and head back into place, abruptly needing to ensure that every hair on her body was immaculate. Biting his fleshy tongue, the horse swallowed hard, hiding behind his forelock as Ansha patiently waited, knowing him better than he knew himself in all truth. It was too much for him to admit right then but he hated to disappoint, so he changed his shake of the head into a quick nod, immediately tucking his muzzle back down against his chest in the next instant.

“Aw, poor pony,” Ansha crooned, patting him upon the head. “We’ll have to ease you out of that modesty. You’ll get used to it soon enough, I promise. My Zonah.”

The horse’s fingers twitched and Edith narrowed her eyes, wagging tail still without warning.

“Ansha,” Edith reprimanded softly. “You know better.”

“Yes, yes.” The canine waved her paw, disregarding Edith’s concern over her teasing. “Slave, you may leave us.” She winked, catching him by the arm as he rose to leave. “But come back later. When you are...rested.”

It was no longer possible for the horse to become redder in the muzzle and he near fled from the room, hooves clapping noisily over the mats and hard floor beneath. Though he raced away as swiftly as was polite, Edith and Ansha could not fail to notice his raised tail and winking tail hole, squeezing and releasing rhythmically. Once he disappeared through the doorway, heading towards the quarters belonging to the servants, Edith turned to Ansha with a disapproving glare.

“Really, Ansha,” Edith clucked her tongue against the roof of her mouth, though the smile on her lips betrayed her mirth. “Did you have to call him ‘Zonah’?”

Is that not what he is?” Ansha blinked innocently. “Besides, he’s cute when he blushes.”

“He’s cute doing a lot of things,” Edith murmured.

“See!” Ansha cackled triumphantly. “Even you admit it!”

“All right,” Edith huffed, leaning back against the recliner. “Have it your way. He’s your slave. Just...go easy on him.”

Ansha traced her tongue over her pointed front teeth, paw returning to its rightful place between her thighs.

“I make no promises.”

*

The sun had yet to rise and Imran was yet to find the comfort of sleep. The palomino stallion sprawled out on a set of rich cushions layered with subtle tones and delicate embroidery; they had cost him a fair sum in coin and other privileges when they had first been acquired. His sleeping quarters were seldom empty and this night was no exception to the rule as a female jackal and male jungle cat curled up together an arm’s length to his right. Glancing at them through the dim, silvery light of the moon and stars, he could not even summon a smile, every muscle aching with pleasant, repeated exertion.

He chewed slowly and repetitively, marvelling upon the wonders of *Khat* and how it kept him in the realm of the waking even after such an exhausting party. The plant was fantastic. And, despite the resulting lethargy, it had been a wonderful party, hosted by a close friend of his. It was likely still going on, he warranted, in some form or another. Mostly probably it had degenerated into an orgy, if the majority was not erotic enough to be considered an orgy to begin with. In his alcohol-laced slumber, the jungle cat grumbled and wormed himself closer to the jackal, whose jaws snapped lightly in unconsciousness, perhaps nipping a dream partner on the throat. Imran rubbed his paw over his throat: she had been fond of that during the course of their heated liaison. It had been more satisfying to make the cat yowl though while pounding into his well-used tail hole.

Unwilling to allow sleep to creep upon him so soon, the horse swept his gaze across the room, taking in the row of small plants near the opening, which allowed cool air into the room. Without the woven blankets crafted from the finest paws, he would have been cold with such a thin, golden coat and a window opening directly on to the street below, but the chill rarely bothered him. Only sometimes would he fasten a blanket across the opening to muffle sound from the outside, but he was far enough away from the main city streets to enjoy the relative peace and quiet. The house was quiet but he knew that the servants were in the lower quarters, slumbering and waiting for the day to begin again, the cycle of work and sleep scant break for their rounds.

He frowned. As pleasant as it was to chew *Khat*, the bitter taste familiar to his taste buds, it sent his mind spinning, senses sharpened to the point that every sound set his ears twitching furiously. His sense of taste was heightened and he felt every tiny hair as he danced his fingertips across his thigh, fascinated by how the sensations played through his sifting nerves. Shifting into a more comfortable position on his side, his flaccid cock slipped over his hip, covered in dry cum and reluctant to return to its sheath. It did not matter if he did not sleep, but he wished the jungle cat would stop that little, rumbling snore of his. He could rest in the morning but rest would not be had if he could not succumb to darkness in the first place. His dreams were far from bright yet shockingly vivid, leaving him gasping awake in a dry sweat, twisted amongst the blankets. He shook his head. What was wrong with him?

His head lolled back on to the cushions and he stared at the flat ceiling, lips pressed into a thin line. He had everything. So why the dissatisfaction? Why the constant wondering for something that was not present and could not be named, sought or acquired? What did he want for? He had everything.

Turning his head to stare out the window, he thought back to another time and another place, perhaps where it had all begun.

Having seen many suns, a younger Imran gasped for breath, sprawling across the same blankets in the same bed chambers, though there were fewer luxurious in his past. A golden-brown Calabrese mare clung to his arm, breasts squeezed into his side as she murmured, thighs soaked with a delectable mixture of his seed and her arousal. Turning his tired muzzle to hers, he kissed her tenderly, trailing a paw over the curve of her hip to the mess between her legs, evidence of their tryst. He ached to thrust his muzzle between her thighs once more, to taste her, to ravish her. And he would.

But first, there was something he had to say. The stallion leaned in close, nibbling lightly upon her curved ear.

"I have an idea," Imran whispered, breath tickling that same ear.

The mare sighed and rocked away.

"What is it this time?" She rolled her eyes, showing the whites for the briefest of moments. "You and your ideas. What might this one be?"

He could not be dissuaded – he had come too far. Swallowing hard, Imran pulled her closer, refusing to allow her to roll away from his body.

"It's time."

"Time for what?" She drew her head back, ears pricked.

"I think it is time for us to leave Sodom," he said plainly, gaze searching for her immediate response.

Blinking, the mare said nothing and Imran took this as his cue to continue.

"I want to travel," he continued, eyes taking on a dreamy cast. "To travel! Find a land new to us to settle and then raise a foal together. It's time, my dear, it is time."

For a moment, he dared to hope. Gracing his young muzzle with a handsome smile, Imran stroked the mare's outer thigh and waited, watching emotion flash across her narrower, more delicate features. Her blue eyes narrowed sharply and she sat up, thrusting him away from her with enough force to make him grunt as she shoved into his chest. And that hope was shattered.

"I can't believe you'd bring this up again!"

Imran's expression dropped and he reached out even as the mare slapped his paw away.

“My sweet, I meant no –”

“Oh, I know exactly what you meant,” she snorted, slipping off the blankets, rising to her hooves and walking away to the window. “And I have told you a hundred times before: that holds no interest for me.”

“Is it such a terrible thing to wish to sire a foal with you?” Imran tossed the question at her without care, temper rising as he scrambled to his knees on the sleeping mat and blankets. “I want a foal! I have all the wealth you and I could ever desire, my business dealing have always been fruitful. What could you ever want for?”

“It is not what I would want for in terms of coin, Imran.”

She leaned out into open space, taking in deep breaths of clean air through her petite nostrils, tiny curves at the tip of her muzzle. Imran hopped to his hooves, pacing up behind her uncertainly, willing his legs to move, to take him closer to her, while his mind screamed to flee. Sliding his paws around her slim waist, he drew her in close to his chest.

“Without Sodom, we could even manage to be with only each other –”

“No! I’ll hear no more of this foolishness!”

She shoved him away, using her hooves to make sure he stayed well at bay, though a scrap from the hard surface to his leg would hardly hurt for all that long. Imran clenched his paws into fists and forcibly relaxed them, meeting her sharp, blue gaze.

“I can support a family of any size for you!” He neighed angrily, tail lashing in his fury. “I can give you anything you want. I have given you all of myself. What more is it that you seek?”

“It’s nothing to do with what coin you do or do not have,” she denied, folding her arms over her chest. “I cannot manage such a life – you know this.”

“You’ve never tried.”

He was beginning to sound like a sulky foal himself but her expression did not soften one iota.

“It is not for me,” she re-stated. “It is nothing I have ever wanted even before I begun spending time with you. Being a dam is not for me and restricting myself to one partner in the bed chambers...” She trailed off, shaking her muzzle incredulously. “Why should I ever desire such a thing? We have such variety!”

“Please...” Imran shuddered, pressing his muzzle into a trembling paw. “Please, don’t do this to me again.”

“You should have listened the first time.”

The mare's eyes narrowed and she tucked a curl of her mane to the side, fussing over its appearance even as tears gathered in the corners of Imran's eyes.

"And the time after that," she continued, laughing a harsh, mirthless whinny. "And the time after that, and the time after that. You never heard me but my story stayed the same all along and my mind never changed. I made no pretence, Imran. You simply chose not to hear me."

Imran recoiled as if she had struck him about the muzzle. Leaning forward, he tensed his legs, thigh muscles quivering. It was hard to believe that only a short time ago he had held this mare in his arms and now she seemed to want nothing more than him a million leagues away. Anger battled with despair in the pit of his belly, sending the bottom of his stomach plummeting somewhere into the region of his hooves. Anxiously, his tail flicked from side to side, swatting away invisible flies, and the object of his frustration took a step backward, eyes suddenly wary. The taller stallion threw his arms in the air, reminding her acutely of their difference in size, though Imran would never raise a paw against her. Or would he?

"I thought you loved me!" Imran lashed out verbally, paws tightening into dangerous fists. "What is so wrong with you? What is so wrong with me? Please, I can give you everything you every asked for and more, I've said this a thousand times. You say you've heard me – why don't you understand me?"

Imran took a deep, shuddering breath, fighting to rein in emotion that threatened to spill over. Silently, the mare shook her head, willing him to say no more but he would not be stopped.

"Please," he begged in a tone so quiet that she had to strain to hear him. "Please consider my side, my love. I care for you more than anything in the world and you mean more to me than anyone else."

"Stop right there."

Her tone conveyed an ice that he had not known existed, halting his verbal tirade mid flow.

"Do you not recall what I told you last time, Imran?" She sighed heavily, running a paw through her neatened mane, sending it awry once more. "I told you and I know you remember. I said that I would never see you again if you brought up this idiocy about leaving Sodom, this insanity about keeping only one another in our bed chamber. No, do not speak." She held up a paw to silence him as his eyes widened and he blurted out an interruption. "You should have remembered. This was a line for me, a line that you trampled over and were well aware of. You shall never see me again, you fool stallion. And you shall never have a hoof in raising my foal."

Imran blinked.

"Your foal? What do you... No! You're not?"

His jaw hung slack and the mare chuckled without any trace of amusement.

"Yes, Imran, I am carrying your foal already, you dim sighted fool," she spat venomously. "You could have had that foal you wanted so much, but we both know what siring a foal

means in Sodom. There is no obligation to have the sire play a part beyond sowing his seed. And you have done that job well, my dear.”

“You cannot mean this!” Imran snapped his teeth together. “You can’t keep me away from my foal! I shall have my part in his life.”

“Not if I keep his birth a secret,” she retorted. “Who’ll believe a raving imbecile like you about some mare that nobody knows carrying his foal? Everyone knows how desperate you are. It’s pathetic.”

“They will know,” Imran insisted, though he couldn’t imagine how he would convince anyone that the foal was his. “How low have you stooped, to hurt me so deeply?”

Throwing her head back, the mare laughed crazily, wrapping her arms around her torso.

“Oh, I’ve hurt you, have I?” She shot back. “Nothing of me then? Nothing of my pain?”

The stallion rolled his eyes and held his paws before him, palms facing up.

“What more could you want for with me?” He repeated. “I can provide everything for you and our foal. Just give me the chance and I will show you, I will prove it to you. Just give me a chance.”

Opening and closing her mouth several times, the mare started to talk and gave up on each utterance in turn until a crazed laugh burst from her lips.

“This again? All that about providing for me when you never want to give me what I truly need! Why can’t you respect me? Why can’t you respect how I feel?” She screamed, mane tumbling wildly about her muzzle. “Again and again – you never listen! I don’t want the life you offer! I’m happy here! In Sodom!”

“Stop it, you don’t –”

“Shut up! I’ve had enough of your shit!”

Her shriek stopped him head, ears pinned flat to his skull, waiting. But she had nothing more to say. Turning on her heel, she glared at him over the sensual curve of her golden shoulder. Where love had once burned in her gaze, now he saw only loathing.

“Have it your way, fool!” She snarled viciously, making a rude gesture. “This is the last you’ll see of me.”

In his desperation, Imran lunged forward, grabbing the mare’s arm and digging his fingertips in to prevent her from leaving, searching for any words that would change her mind, have her back in his arms. She whipped about like a snake and struck him across the muzzle, leaving a burning imprint and the stallion blinking dully, head reeling. Stepping out of his reach, the mare made a rude gesture, standing in the doorway without even any of her clothes as she prepared her exit.

“Don’t you fucking touch me,” she hissed.

With that, she was gone, the last Imran ever saw of her golden-brown muzzle, twisted in hate. He stood stock still in the centre of the room, pale tale flattened over his rump as he rubbed something from the corners of his eyes. Not tears, never tears. He would not, could not, admit to that. She would be back, would she not? She had always come back before. But, this time, Imran knew in the depths of his gut that she would not return. He had lost her and his foal forever.

Hoof steps echoed across the courtyard, but he did not step to the window to watch her skulk away. Why? He could have all the questions he desired, yet they would never now be answered. He put his hands behind his head, tilting his muzzle back to stare at the ceiling, listening intently. Tap, tap, tap – hooves on hard packed soil were distinctive and he memorised every minute sound, locking the instances away in a corner of his mind for safekeeping. He may need them at a later date. Her hoof falls faded into the distance as his heartbeat thudded in his ears, blood roaring too loudly in his skull to allow focus.

Nearby, a bird shrieked, breaking the silence, and, once again alone, Imran collapsed to the floor and sobbed.

*

Standing on the step of the inn that she had learned to call home, Esther cocked her muzzle. No one paid attention to her, though furs hurried past on the street to her rear – it was a busy thoroughfare, after all. Strangely enough for her natural disposition, she felt safest in crowds, knowing that there were too many eyes and bodies for any one fur to single her out from the heaving mass. Seconds ticked by as she dallied outside, dancing from hind paw to paw as she fought to summon the courage to enter the inn. Would her cousin be there – Malachi? She did not know if she would be more relieved if he was otherwise disposed or if he was busying himself within.

She took a deep breath: she had to be strong. It would not be that hard to go in. But what would Malachi say to her? What if she'd disappointed him by running away? She had not meant to, but that was a ridiculous thing to say. How could one unconsciously flee a city? Tucking her tail between her legs, she raised a paw and tapped twice firmly on the door, willing herself not to tremble. She had to face him.

Clothing ruffled on the other side of the door and she held her breath as it swung open, revealing the taller Corsac fox. The bags beneath his eyes had deepened and he stared at Esther for longer than was polite, gears turning slowly in his brain as Esther slanted her ears back bashfully. She had never seen Malachi so surprised and it took a great effort of will for the vixen to not let out a crazed little chuckle.

“Esther?” Malachi blinked, jaw hanging slack, one paw still half-raised as if he had forgotten what action it was supposed to complete in pushing open or closing the door. “What are you... Esther!”

Lunging forward, he dragged her into his arms, squeezing her tightly to his broader chest. So crushed, the vixen squirmed but good-naturedly endured the hug, relaxing into it the best she could. The contact came more easily than it had prior to her liaison with Lot and his daughters and she felt a flash of pride momentarily, though it was swept away as quickly as it

appeared as Malachi squeezed her closer, betraying his emotion with actions rather than words. Esther took a shuddering breath and closed her eyes, a wave of shame crashing over her.

“I’m sorry,” she whined into his neck. “I didn’t mean –”

“Shush, it’s okay, I know, I understand,” Malachi babbled, eyes moist with emotion. “I’m just so happy you’ve returned, my dear! You would not believe what we’ve been doing to try to find you!”

He held her away from his body suddenly, looking her up and down as if to check the vixen for any sign of harm. Thus satisfied, he smiled warmly. The vixen tilted her head, confusion dancing in her gaze.

“To find...me?” Esther repeated uncertainly. “Why would you expend so much energy to find me, cousin?”

“I only have one cousin like you,” Malachi said, steering her inside and closing the door. “Come, come! Much has happened in your absence. You have a story to tell me indeed, I am confident of it.”

The beaming fox grabbed her paw and towed her gently into the reception room where a duo gaped in surprise akin to Malachi’s upon setting eyes upon Esther. The Nile crocodile turned his blocky muzzle from side to side and clapped the fire salamander – black with wicked orange blotches all over his body – upon the shoulder, sending the smaller reptile stumbling forward, though both their grins were perpetual.

“Well, who would have guessed it?” The crocodile flashed an exceptionally toothy grin. “Esther, the lady of the moment.”

Shrinking into her cousin’s side, the vixen did her best to appear as small and insignificant as possible. Malachi wrapped a reassuring arm around her waist and held her close, letting her shift as close to him as needed, even if the crocodile and salamander were nothing to be afraid of. On the contrary, he no longer had need of their assistance in one particular matter, or so it seemed.

“All this and she turns up outside the inn!” Malachi declared. “I couldn’t believe it.”

“We are having a difficult time believing it also,” the salamander said with a broad, genial smile, his eyes soft. “I cannot say how glad we are to see you well and home again, Esther.”

“Oh...thank you.”

Esther ducked her muzzle, unable to halt the flush that crept up her neck, rising crimson beneath her pale fur.

“Please, all of us,” Malachi waved his paws. “Please, be seated, there is no need to stand around. Our search is over!”

“At least in part,” the crocodile commented as he folded into a crouch, choosing not to utilise the padded cushions around the low table. “We have three bodies unaccounted for.”

“That is very true.”

The male Corsac fox hesitated with one leg curled beneath him, half-sitting but not quite there.

“Did you return with Lot, Pheine and Thamma?” He asked of his cousin.

Swallowing hard, Esther nodded, hoping against hope that he wouldn’t pry further. It was inevitable, of course, even if she strove to forestall what she could. The salamander, as yet a stranger to her, leaned forward, pale eyes shining as a black tongue flicked out to moisten his lips.

“That is one relief to be had at the very least,” he said slowly, choosing each word with great care. “And all are well?”

Esther’s nod was slower coming the second time but she nodded all the same, alleviating the trio’s concerns. Malachi beamed. Edith would be thrilled to have her daughters back, he thought, though perhaps not so much her husband, from what she had imparted to him.

“What happened out there?” Malachi probed, pouring Esther a cup of wine that she gladly took, to his surprise – she had not been much of one for liquor previously. “You were indeed with Lot and his daughters, were you not?”

“Yes, I was.” Esther turned her muzzle away, wondering if her blush was to become a permanent feature: it had surely seared into her skin and fur by now.

“And?” Malachi bit his tongue, desperate for answers but knowing Esther too well to shake them from her. “Why did you leave, dear? I missed you. I know there was a lot of confusion around the time of the festival. Was it too much for you?”

Esther shook her head.

“No, the festival was just fine,” she reassured him. “You were letting me stay here, I didn’t have to go out in it. I’m not sure why I left, if I may be frank with you, cousin.”

Malachi raised an eyebrow. She was never frank.

“I’m not sure if this is something I should say here,” she shivered. “A lot happened. A lot.”

“You’re in safe company, my dear,” Malachi smiled. “It cannot be all that bad.”

“You...” Esther growled, surprising them all. “You have no idea.”

Eyes wide, Malachi reached out to his cousin, fearing absurdly that she had been possessed by some malign spirit. Esther *never* growled.

“Esther,” the reptile narrowed his eyes, black pupil slits sharp. “It cannot be that bad. You must trust us.”

“I trust you as much as I can,” she sighed heavily, all the breath rushing from her body in one deep exhalation. “But there was a... There was...an orgy.”

The room dropped into stone dead silence, each rasping breath sounding louder than the last. Outside, a young cub shrieked in joy, providing an awkward juxtaposition to the tension inside, the pure and utter shock encompassing the amphibian and reptile. Had they not been told how shy and reserved the vixen was? The lady Malachi described to them originally, in commencing the search and quest for information, was far from the admittedly shy but steely vixen sitting before them now. Esther peeked beneath her lashes, glancing at each in turn until her gaze finally rested upon Malachi. Her cousin lifted a paw and dropped it again, a shiver making his fur fluff up though not from cold.

“I must have misheard,” Malachi gulped. “You mean with other furs, don’t you Esther?”

“Yes,” Esther closed her eyes, unwilling to look her cousin in the eye. “I was with them. Lot, Pheine and Thamma. We were the only ones involved in the...orgy. I was involved.”

It was nothing shameful but it felt like it in hindsight. If she had not been so enamoured by the thought of Lot in that cave and grinning with wine, perhaps she would have been telling a different story upon her return. It had been so hard to resist after going so long denied, even without an orgasm by her own paw. She could not deny her sexual needs, regardless of her requirement to subdue that need due to the gender her body still displayed. Hanging her head, the vixen quietly awaited judgement. Malachi coughed into his paw, straining not to breathe as his pulse jumped in his neck. The corner of his eyes twitched but, with his companions in the same room, he could say nothing about Esther’s true identity. To them, she was a natural female with nothing unusual about her, besides her reserved demeanour if that could be counted as strange.

“That is obscene!” The salamander broke the silence, finding his tongue and slamming his fist on to the table, knocking over two cups of wine. “Lot had his *daughters*! Why, he should already be judged and begging forgiveness!”

“Heavens know what will happen to him,” the crocodile agreed solemnly.

“Oh, I think we know well enough.”

The rolling, dripping cups cast a purple stain over the small table, but Malachi’s stomach was in knots, too wound up to care for his possessions and that of the inn.

“What...will happen to Lot?” Esther looked up, misunderstanding; they were less concerned with what she had done than what Lot had done.

“Esther,” Malachi wrapped an arm around her shoulders, half pulling her off the cushions. “I’m so sorry this happened. You seem to be taking it rather well. Are you okay? Do you need anything?”

“Why would I need anything?”

“After your...ordeal,” Malachi tried to phrase it as delicately as possible.

Esther’s eyes widened in sudden comprehension and a wild bubble of laughter threatened to burst from her lips, surely ensuring they deemed her crazy if she let it into the open air. Calm, calm, she had to be calm.

“What?” Her voice trembled with suppressed, dry amusement. “No, no, you have me wrong, cousin. Lot did not rape me or his daughters. If anything, Pheine was the greatest instigator. I was just a little too far gone on wine to want to stop things as they, um, progressed.”

“Pheine?” Malachi’s pitch rose. “You’re telling me that *Pheine* was responsible for this?”

“Well, Thamma played a big part too. Lot hardly any,” Esther added as an afterthought, tracing a finger across the line of her jaw. “Really he was too drunk to even consider such a thing. He ranted on about sex being this abhorrent thing for such a long time, it was strange to wake up in the morning and find that he had, well, done it.”

The Corsac fox made a strangled noise and slapped the flat of his paw down on the table, sending one of the fallen wine cups tumbling to the floor.

“I *cannot* believe that,” Malachi opened and closed his mouth several times. “The Pheine I know... Well, I don’t really know her, but I know enough about her! The fact is that Pheine would never do that, I simply can’t believe that Esther. How could you say such a thing?”

“But it’s true!”

Esther sat bolt upright, skin tingling as her fur stood on end. What did he mean that he could not believe her? It was the truth and nothing but the truth! Glaring at Malachi like she had never done before, the little vixen crossed her arms firmly across her chest, ears pinned back defiantly. The salamander held out his paws, calming the pair of near snarling foxes.

“Why would she lie, Malachi?” He said quietly, mind not completely on the topic at hand. “Are you trying to protect Lot, my dear?” He directed the second utterance at Esther.

Feeling sillier by the second, Esther tried to understand what she was being asked, the tip of her tail flicking rapidly in subtle distress. She suddenly found that she disliked feeling stupid, something that she had never noticed prior. Then again, she had rarely asked questions in the past. Taking heed of fresh boldness, she steadied her nerve.

“Why would I need to protect Lot?” Esther tilted her head, a cute trait that the salamander tried to ignore, lest he become uncomfortably distracted.

The salamander coughed lightly, looking between Malachi and his other male companion. How could he put it? He paused for too long, however.

“Because he had sex with his daughters,” the crocodile interjected, rolling his eyes as if tired of the others incompetence. “You should know as well as us that all other furs will see that as rape, non-consent, however you wish to phrase it.”

“But...it wasn’t,” Esther muttered lamely, twisting her paws in her lap. “It wasn’t him, he didn’t rape them. No one did. They wanted to do it, I know. Does that mean *I* raped Pheine and Thamma? They dragged me on to them!”

Pitch rising tremulously, Esther shrank back, mind throwing up awful images before her frightened eyes. Dark cells, dirty fur, gleaming eyes in the shadows and something that scuttled over her hind paws. A rat? She shivered, forgetting where she was until Malachi shook her shoulder roughly, yanking her from the horrifying vision. Gratefully, she shot him a quick smile, though her lips could not remain quirked for long.

“Why would you be accused of rape?” The salamander questioned, slowly and carefully choosing his words as he slid his gaze to the left, thinking. “There is no reason why you should not enjoy yourself with other female furs. I’m sure it’s more comfortable for you.”

Esther’s eyes shot wide. She had forgotten for a moment that neither of those furs, strangers to her, knew her true gender and she swiftly backtracked. Malachi clicked his tongue against the roof of his mouth disapprovingly.

“Rahmiel,” Malachi addressed the salamander. “That is no way to speak to my cousin, refrain from such assumptions.”

Huffing out a light laugh, Rahmiel settled back on his rump, tucking his black tail carefully to one side, hardly dissuaded at all.

“I assume Pheine and Thamma would collude with your story?” He continued, questioning her easily. “There would be no problems, would there?”

“They, um, ah...”

Esther did not know how much she was permitted to say. Did it matter? She shrugged, slumping forward.

“They desperately wanted to become pregnant,” she confessed. “Thamma had some part in it but Pheine orchestrated most of the liaison. I don’t know what she had in her head but somehow she thought there was no other way to have pups.”

“And she told you this?” The crocodile demanded, thumping his tail on the floor once again.

“She didn’t tell me,” Esther flushed. “But she was quite vocal when speaking about it with Thamma.”

“Did you have sex with Lot too?” The reptile turned his massive head to the side. “Are you sure it was consensual?”

I didn’t literally have intercourse with him...not really.

“No,” Esther replied simply. “And it certainly was consensual. I would never do it against my will.”

The truth did not ring in that statement but Esther said it aloud anyway, knowing they would not question her. It would be inane to believe otherwise of any fur, let alone one that had grown up within the walls of Sodom. Satisfied, the three bobbed their muzzles in mutual agreement, attention shifting from the trembling Corsac fox and what sexual acts she had or had not taken part in. It was all becoming too much: boldness only lasted so long and she had much to learn still.

“May I ask how you returned to Sodom, my dear?” Malachi asked gently.

“The search party found us,” Esther said quietly. “They did not pay much mind to me but near dragged Lot back to Sodom. The daughters came more quietly.”

Malachi patted her shoulder gently, though even the familiar motion appeared awkward in the moment. The Nile crocodile heaved a sigh, huge chest expanding with air.

“That settles it,” he said, tone unexpectedly grim. “Lot has been arrested. Do you understand the implications of this?”

“There’s no other option in the matter,” Malachi bobbed his muzzle. “You can imagine how it looked. Well, Esther’s been quite clear about what happened. Under the normal course of events, it is against our laws. Whether it is a moral wrong when the daughters *desired* the act...that is another case entirely.”

“But they wanted it,” Esther repeated flatly, shrinking back down on to her cushion. “There is no denying it.”

The salamander shook his head.

“Lot will be tried,” Rahmiel warned. “What will you do in that case?”

“The only right thing would be to speak for him at the trial.” Esther was surprised anyone would consider any other option.

Malachi blinked, stumped by her forthright answer. He was still unused to the old vixen. The others, however, had only the image of the shy vulpine painted in their minds.

“Why would you?” The crocodile swung his blocky head to face her. “Why would you defend Lot at trial? What love do you have for him? I am not entirely convinced that all is as you say. Perhaps it takes observance to truly believe the shocking.”

Esther opened and closed her muzzle several times, fighting for the best words that would not spring wilfully to her lips. How could there be any other option? Could she allow an innocent male be convicted of something that he was not guilty of? Should Pheine and Thamma have been arrested? It was too much to think about. The vixen sat up straight, thrusting back her rounded shoulders.

“It is the right thing to do,” she insisted. “Would you not do the same in my position?”

The crocodile’s lips twitched.

“We only wonder what you are hiding.”

“That’s quite enough,” Malachi cut in, tail flicking against his leg. “There is nothing to hide and I certainly do not appreciate you making such accusations of my cousin.”

The crocodile had the good grace to appear repentant, offering a large paw to Esther, which she took timidly. Stroking a thumb over the back of her paw, he tried for a less intimidating smile – a challenge in itself with his teeth.

“My deepest apologies.” He sounded sincere, something that Esther had the caution to doubt. “I intended no offence.”

Esther gave a tiny nod, gently extracting her paw and folding it into the other in her lap. The room appeared to blur, voices murmuring into one as if she was hearing them from a great distance away. Oh, if only she could curl into her nice, cool blankets and sink into the sleeping mat. Seven darks of rest would be vastly appreciated.

“My friends.” Malachi spread his arms wide, a faint smile brightening his muzzle; he was a master of social situations and Esther could not have been more grateful for that fact. “It is late in the afternoon and my cousin needs to rest. If there is more to discuss, perhaps we could convene on the morrow?”

“Of course,” Rahmiel rose fluidly, ever the gracious guest. “We would not want to tire you, Esther.”

The crocodile swiftly followed in his actions, lumbering to his hind paws in a far less delicate manner. Esther noticed, fascinated, that he used his tail for balance. A stray thought darted through the forefront of her mind and she wondered how he used that tail in the water. Under different circumstances, she would have enquired after a demonstration.

“We will arrange another meeting,” the crocodile agreed, snapping her from her musings. “Once we have determined Lot’s whereabouts, we will meet again. First we must determine the location and time of his trial and then we may have more to talk on.”

“Lot should not be difficult to locate at this stage,” the salamander commented dryly. “He is under arrest, after all. Surely you cannot think that will take a time.”

“No,” the crocodile rolled his eyes, the only symptom of aggravation he had displayed throughout the entire interview. “I was considering the matter of the trial and how our city makes a deal of them. It will hardly be a private affair. Everyone will want to have their say on the matter.”

He met Esther’s eyes, the vulpine quietly drinking in every drop of information he offered.

“Guilty or innocent, that canine will not slink through this ordeal without everything becoming painfully public, mark my words.”

Choosing not to answer, the vixen looked away, instead turning to her cousin.

“My friends,” Malachi gently regained their attention. “Is there anything I may fetch for you?”

“No, nothing at all,” the salamander smiled; he had an easy smile, lips curving readily. “Forgive my companion his lack of diplomacy. I fear he has never been weary a day in his life, dragging me about the city as he does on one mission or another.”

“I trust you are very busy.” Malachi’s lips twisted sympathetically.

“If you please,” Rahmiel nodded his muzzle to Esther, polite in his retreat. “My dear, I hope you recover your strength quickly and feel more like yourself.”

I’m better than myself.

Ushering the others ahead of him, Malachi wagged his tail, his relief palatable. It went without saying that there had been some close calls in that meeting and he would be counting his lucky stars later that night.

What am I doing? Esther thought, remaining upon her cushion as the threesome filed out, Malachi at the tail end. *There is a deal to convict Lot, just not for laying with his daughters. Maybe that is a crime, yet Lot is anything but the perpetrator.*

An image flashed unbidden before her eyes. She saw Lot with the wine skin pressed to his lips, throat bulging and narrowing alternately as the nectar disappeared down his gullet. Perhaps he had not wanted anything to do with sexual activity but food and wine had been his vices, evidenced by his large belly and swollen demeanour. Everything about him was bloated past the point of recognition, of life. All too vividly, she recalled how his daughters shrunk away from him when he was in one of his spats of anger, paws stomping and fists swinging. He had never laid a paw on either of them – not that she had seen – but Esther had not dismissed the notion that it was a distinct possibility. Had it once happened? She could not rule it out.

And, if Lot was such a fur to abuse his daughters, should she defend him at his trial? Ears twitching, Esther half-listened to Malachi sending off his companions, voices murmuring at the inn door. Their return would be something hardly anticipated.

The vixen shook herself. Enough of such thoughts! What good would over thinking do? What could would running over and over events do her mind? She knew that answer well enough for herself. She was suddenly uncomfortably aware of how her shoulders ached, the road resting heavy upon them.

Time to retire for the evening, Esther mused, shifting her weight as weariness set in to her hind paws. *It could not hurt to relax for one night.*

Malachi remained at the door, voice rising in a bubble of laughter. All tension woven within the room had been forgotten as he joked with his companions, a lighter individual than he had been. Malachi would not miss her for a time: he knew where to find her now. Demonstrating surprising agility in her tiredness, Esther sprung upright, tail waving gently for balance. Was everything still as it was? There was only one way to find out. Padding softly to the pantry, Esther rifled through several clay pots, soon rediscovering her stash of herbs. Bringing the

leafy greens – bleached from sun and dryness – to her muzzle, she inhaled deeply. More than any cushions, stout walls or a roof over her head, the soft, comforting aroma of the herbs told her that she was indeed home.

And about time too.

*

“You are sure it’s them? You are sure, are you not?”

The golden Arabian counted to five slowly, lest he release a less than polite sigh. It had taken too long, far too long, but it was the final minutes leading up to reunion that he was finding the most grating. Pacing the small room, which was situated near the central meeting square of Sodom, Edith wound herself up in circles.

“Edith.” Imran suppressed the urge to roll his eyes. “I have told you, my dear, it can be no one else. Yes, they are back.”

“And Lot too?” The Canaan dog danced from one hind paw to the other, demonstrating the perfect image of a young lady who urgently needed the latrine.

Imran sighed this time, coupling the display of aggravation with an appeasing nod. He just had to be patient a little longer, it would not be so bad. Flicking his long tail, the equine glanced between Edith and the door, lips parting and closing as he chose and discarded words in turn.

“Edith, I must warn you –”

She was not listening. Her gaze rested intent upon the main door, ears pricked as eagerly as a young pup awaiting a treat. Imran could not deny himself a smile at the sight. It made him wish to take the canine into his arms and show her the family she had missed so much. Only...what if there was something missing. Edith’s fur bristled with excitement: there were voices outside. Sensing time was short, Imran darted for the canine, reaching out even as he began speaking.

Imran caught her arm, turning the trembling canine to face him.

“I have to warn you, Edith,” he said clearly, making her look him in the eyes. “There’s something not right here.”

“Warn me?” Her voice caught in her throat, eyes slipping back against her skull. “Warn me of what? Are they hurt?”

“No, not that I know of.” Imran’s brow furrowed and he shook his head. “Something is amiss. Something.”

“That’s hardly reassuring,” Edith snorted, forgetting her manners in a rare moment of obscure anxiety. “What do you think could be wrong? Why would you say that?”

Oh, just the way no one else would give me a straight answer, Imran thought. But he could not say that – it would only worry Edith more. The voices outside drew closer, disallowing him from making a further decision. He was simply out of time.

“We shall soon see, either way,” Imran murmured to no one in particular, his comment falling on deaf ears.

The door swung inward, revealing a stern jackal with shocking amber eyes. Following at his heels and sandwiched between the jackal and another bulky fur, Lot entered, muzzle pointing at the ground. Edith stepped forward as if to embrace him and paused in the next heartbeat. The older canine held his paws awkwardly behind his back and it was only upon craning her neck at a bizarre angle that Edith realised that they were securely tied so that he could not bring them forward at all.

“Lot?” Edith laughed aloud. “What on earth have you on your paws? Are you well? Where are Pheine and Thamma?”

Lot raised his muzzle slowly, refusing to meet her eyes. Slowly, he looked over his wife’s new attire, seeing her dressed in a loose relaxed robe that hung nicely from her curvaceous frame, accentuating rather than hiding. He, on the other paw, wore his tattered robe from the road, not being deemed worth enough to

“Lot?” Edith huffed, resting one paw on her hip. “Do you have so little to say to me?”

“Edith...” He mumbled, words rolling over one another. “I did not mean to. I did not mean it.”

“What are you speaking of?” She blinked. “Honestly.”

Whether Lot was cowed by the newly discovered spark in his wife or his predicament, onlookers could only speculate. Edith’s gaze slid beyond and her eyes brightened. She cared for Lot, that much was true, but it was her daughters that she truly craved to see. Tucked between three other furs – why did they have bodyguards? – Pheine and Thamma’s muzzles stretched into wide grins and they started forward in the same instant as their mother, arms outstretched.

“Pheine, Thamma,” Edith started, relief thick in her voice. “It’s so good...”

She trailed off, paws falling to her sides. She had meant to draw her daughters into her arms. She had meant to hold them close, remind them how much they meant to her. They were right there! Standing with her arms hopefully outstretched, Pheine’s smile faltered and she looked to her sister. Edith tried to speak, lips parting, but no words were forthcoming, failing her in the moment that she needed them most.

“Mother?” Thamma tilted her head to the side, muzzle flushing as her paws moved to cover her belly. “Mother...please do not look at us like that.”

How could she not stare? How could her stomach not plummet? Shaking her head, Edith folded her arms over her chest and unfolded them an instant later. Her paws twitched with a mind of their own, restlessly moving from one body part to another as if by reminding herself

of her body's contours she could reinstate herself in reality. Because her daughters could not be part of any waking world. She had not considered that they may return...different.

Edith had not counted on them being pregnant.

And the only male they had been in the company of was Lot. It was cruelly obvious why the male dog's paws were tied and Edith rounded on him with the fury of a caged beast thus released.

"What have you done to them?" Edith's voice rose, twisting into a shriek. "It was *you*, wasn't it? Tell me now! What have you done?"

Not giving him the chance to respond, Edith launched herself, fingers curled into vicious imitations of claws: her own blunt ones would not suffice for the damage she intended to cause. She could imagine how it would feel to tear into him, make him pay for what he'd done. He had not even had the manhood to give her a reason, not that she would listen to another word of his bile ever again. She was almost within clawing distance when furs moved to block her path but that did not faze her – she would barrel through them! And then she jerked back abruptly, stopping foot short of the blank-faced Lot as a heavy weight dragged upon her left arm.

"Mother!" Pheine clung to her arm, holding her back solely with the weight of her own body. "Stop this now! This is madness! Father was not to blame."

"Pheine!" Torn, Edith stepped away, pulling her daughter with her, away from the male dog. "Don't jump about, you can't..."

She sagged forward, conflicted between the primal urge to sink her teeth into Lot's jugular and to take care of Pheine. She couldn't bounce around anymore! She had to think of the cub. Pheine's vice grip loosened, believing her mother to be in control of her own actions once more. Standing up tall, the female canine seethed.

"Pheine, Thamma," Edith said curtly, straightening her robe. "Please go to the other side of the room."

"Mother?" Thamma rested her paw on Edith's arm. "Please do not do this. We can explain, I promise you."

The older canine gently gave Thamma's paw back, eyes as stern as when she had had two pups, not two pregnant daughters.

Pregnant.

"Now."

Thamma swallowed hard and turned away, meekly doing as she was bid. Pheine joined her on the far side of the room, paws folded protectively over her belly. And when had she developed that habit? Edith's heart wrenched. Too young, she was too young. She needed more experience, more life. The watching guards stood by, cautiously observant of every shift in muscle. Edith knew some of Sodom and it was with a vicious delight that she realised

they would not put a stop to her actions. What Lot had done was not only morally twisted but a true crime in Sodom.

“It was not Lot,” Pheine said loudly, ensuring her voice cut through her mother’s furious haze.

“Then who was it?” Edith questioned in a monotone, eyes riveted on her husband.

Pheine hesitated.

“It was your father who got you with pups?” The older canine pressed, voice rising at the end of the statement to pose it clearly as a question.

“Yes, father has put pups in us,” Pheine admitted, though her eyes blazed. “But it was *my* idea.”

“Your idea?” Edith barked a laugh at the notion. “Darling, I understand you love your father, though I can no longer fathom why, but this is wrong. What he did was *wrong*.”

There was to be no further discussion in the matter. Keeping her daughters at her back, Edith placed herself between her husband and them, using her body as a shield. She was sure her daughters would not even want to look at him.

But she looked at him. Taking in every inch of his lolling physique, Edith wrinkled his nose. The old dog smelled. He may as well have slept in his own shit for all the good it did him. Filth emanated from him like a wave of heat, smacking her about the head in sudden, dark clarity. Out of the corner of her eye, she noticed a guard take a pace forward, only to be halted by one of his companions. A bubble of crazed laughter threatened to break loose and Edith held it down the best she could. Trying to stop *her*? From what? She would not kill Lot. He deserved worse than that. Despite it lacking dignity, she stretched up on to the tips of her toes, putting her muzzle within an inch of Lot’s. Still, he would not look at her, so she clamped her paw around his snout, forcing his head up, staring straight into his eyes. They were fresh wrinkles in the corners than she remembered.

“You disgust me.”

Pulling her paw back, she snaked it forward in one quick motion, striking her husband across the cheek. She had not thought fit to keep her claws out of the way and they dug in through the dirty fur, slicing skin that was as tainted as the dog that wore it. Lot recoiled, a low grunt of pain passing his lips as he staggered back, crashing bodily into a feline guard. The guard made a noise of disgust and pushed him away, forcing the old dog to find his own hind paws once more: he would find no sympathy from them. Edith’s paw stung and she curled her fingers into a fist, jumping forward as her fist swung simultaneously, this time landing a blow to her husband’s stomach. Lot’s eyes shot wide and his muzzle gaped comically, breath reeking as Edith was treated to the full force of his rankness at close quarters. Muzzle wrinkling, she stepped away and shook out her paw, releasing the hold that had kept Lot upright, if hunched over like a cripple. He sank to the ground like a sack of rotten fruit, crumpling and wheezing as he struggled for breath that had been forced too suddenly from unprepared lungs.

Behind her, Thamma gasped and Edith flushed hotly, one thought after the other flickering through the forefront of her mind. Had she gone too far? No, she should not feel guilty, that was wrong. Nothing would be too far. Adjusting her robe as if she had done no more than walk across the room, Edith locked eyes with the nearest guards and raised her paw.

“Take him away.”

“At once.”

Closing in around Lot, the guards blocked him from view and hustled him out the door as if they had rehearsed the motion. All too swiftly, his wife and daughters were swept from sight and, though he ached to return, he had neither the heart nor the strength to plead his case. He doubted he would ever be given the chance to. In the street, Lot plodded with his head down, gut throbbing from the force of Edith’s blow. Passing furs jeered and threw small stones at him, only called to stop when the pebbles grew in size, one striking him across the temple. It was as if everyone knew what he had done, who he was and where he was going.

Pausing, Lot lifted one hind paw and then the other, trying to shake off the weariness that seemed to have set in to stay. Oh, what he would give for another chance, another fate. The guards were less patient with his musings.

“Keep moving!” The jackal snarled, shoving him between the shoulder blades. “We don’t keep rapists in the streets.”

Lot heaved a sigh.

A rapist was all he had become.

*

The cell was cold. That should have been a blessing in the scorching climate, yet Lot could not find joy in the sensation of cool stone against his fur.

He had been left with little clothing – nothing more than a simple loincloth and the folds were caked with dirt. No one would have given him clean ones or allowed him to wash his – a female’s task – even if he had asked. Lot did not care to ask. Every night and day was the same, spent in solitude. He was aware that he was awaiting trial and he understood why, though the reasons behind his own actions remained closed to him, a distant past that could not be unravelled into reality. Sometimes the guards stopped by his cell to look in, their eyes quiet and seething with pent up fury. He could only imagine what would happen if they had been on the same side of his bars.

His cell was as simple as the life carrying him along. Rectangular in shape, the walls were uneven and rough with old stone. The door was heavy wood with a small gap on the upper third, barred, which the guards pushed food through upon occasion, when they felt like it. He pissed and defecated in the corner, not even in an urination pot; sometimes the mess was cleared, sometimes it was left to stink. It was one small thing to be thankful for that the mess had been scraped away by one of the few prison slaves late in that afternoon. Clean air drifted through the small, high slit of a window in his cell – better appreciated without an unwelcome stench.

The little things had become important to Lot.

He lay stretched out on the bare sleeping mat, devoid of even a blanket for some appearance of comfort. A stray dog barked somewhere, yapping at an obnoxiously high pitch. Lot almost had time to be annoyed, ears twitching as they strove to avoid, ignore, displace the shrill noise. The dog would not stop running back and forth, paws tap-tapping along the dusty ground. What would it take for a male to have a little peace in a cell? The canine grumbled half-heartedly to himself and rolled over, only succeeding in half turning on to his right side: his bulk would not allow him to get any further without a greater exertion of effort. The dog ran back and forth, back and forth. Lot raised his head. That was not a dog, or if it was a god, it was not some stray feral roaming the streets. Someone was outside. Cloth brushed along the exterior wall and further around the complex of cells, the main door clunked and groaned.

Someone was inside.

Slumping on to his back, Lot stared at the ceiling, finding himself oddly empty. It was probably one of the guards come to check on the prison. But the guards went home in the evening, they went back to their families: he knew this. So who was it? Against his obstinate will, the canine's curiosity simmered to the surface. Many furs knew of his crime in explicit detail – his journey through the streets had taught him that much. Their anger, the rocks they had thrown, the way they had screamed. *Rapist. Mongrel. Unclean. Sinner.* Once, he would have called them sinners. Oh, how times had changed. And had one of the enraged mob come to ensure he would not sin again?

Strangely detached from reality, it seemed all too easy for Lot to lay as still as a corpse, following the progress of the strange fur throughout the prison. There were other inmates, but they came and went, more often leaving than returning. Lot could only assume that justice in Sodom was swift and decisive. The fur walked slowly through the narrow halls, pausing so often that even Lot could deduce that he was stopping at the door of every cell he or she came across, checking its occupants. One prisoner grumbled, swearing loudly, and the silent fur quickly moved on, his steps hastening as Lot grappled with the wish to feel but not feel, to be but not be. He imagined that the good Lord had sent his angel to bring justice upon him, bring him to rights. Though the canine was no longer confident in what rights he deserved. Probably done.

The stranger paused outside Lot's cell, fiddling with a key in the lock. If Lot had been himself, he would have wondered why the stranger had keys. That fact did not seem to matter to the dog in the moment, however, and he only blinked slowly, maintaining the same position as he stared up and up and up. Something in the lock clicked – the catch. Lot's ears twitched towards the sound against his will, conscious thought deserting him as instinct and bodily reaction took over.

The cell door swung inward with a groan of protest, but Lot could not bring himself to consider the notion of moving. Whoever it was and whatever their intentions, he had no will to stop them. Please – he had the audacity to beg – let them finish his life for him. He surely had no hope of changing it or living any longer. Against his will, a flicker of hope blossomed in his chest as a strange fur shuffled beyond the door, delaying entry. It was the only shard of jagged hope he had felt in days or weeks. Time and life itself blurred into one continuous

shadow in the cell. He did not deserve release. Please let someone be kind, kind in the darkest of fashions. Had they really come to kill him? Had someone broken into the prison?

A black and white rabbit stepped around the door, paws clasped to his chest, and Lot's hope vanished like a candle being blown out at the eve of the day. It was only Raguel; the rabbit would not do a thing to help. Indeed, it was Lot himself who had travelled so far to assist Raguel when events had conspired against him, all for the rabbit that he had yet to see take any matter into his own paws. The old canine rolled on to his back and snorted his derision, staring at the ceiling. He should be left to die. But guilt would not be denied and it so battled for dominance. He could not possibly be disappointed to see Raguel. Raguel never meant any harm, nor caused it.

"My friend," Lot sat up. "What has brought you to these lonely quarters? It is surely not safe to be here."

He leaned to the side, squinting as he peered around the rabbit in the darkness. Raguel stood still, every muscle trembling as if he had run a race, and his long whiskers twitched erratically.

"Did the guards let you in? I thought they had returned home for the night, no longer guarding the main doors. They always go to their homes for the night." He hesitated, looking up the length of Raguel's body as the otherwise frail-looking rabbit towered over him. "You are not supposed to be here. No one is supposed to be here."

"But...I am here, Lot."

It was the obvious and Lot chuckled under his breath without humour. Of course Raguel was there: Lot could see him. He doubted that his dreams could ever be so vivid. Though the dreams he had been having were something not worth thinking about. Some of them had even featured the rabbit.

Just what had Sodom done to him?

Shaking himself, Lot rolled slowly over on to his paws and knees, pushing himself up so that he sat back on his heels, paws resting flat upon each of his massive thighs. Fat squashed to either side of muscle and bone, half concealed by fur, and Lot looked the rabbit up and down, taking in every inch of his appearance. The rabbit had seen better days. Raguel's eyes darted around the small cell as if he was searching for an escape route, which was absurd as he blocked the only exit for Lot, if it was Lot that he feared. Clearing his throat, the rabbit brought a paw to his muzzle, stroked his whiskers and lowered the same paw again, eyes hopelessly restless. His fur could have done with a good groom, even if Lot did say so himself.

"Lot?"

Raguel's voice was unusually high pitched and Lot looked up in response, noting how tall the rabbit appeared from his lower vantage point. The rabbit had it better than he. Raguel was not waiting in a prison cell to die, awaiting a trial that could only have one possible outcome. A burble of insane laughter rose in the canine's chest, threatening to burst forth in a cackle of

madness. Raguel – poor, unkempt Raguel – was in a better position than Lot. Why had he even taken the journey to aid his friend in the first place.

No, he could not think like that. Swinging from one extreme to the next, Lot lowered his head so that his chin brushed his bare chest. He had to think of his friend; it was all he could do. Why did Raguel not speak?

“Raguel,” Lot heaved a sigh. “You have to leave.”

“No!” The statement startled a shrill yelp from the rabbit that echoed around the prison. “I won’t leave without you! I’ve come for you, Lot, it is all as I said, I would never leave you here to die.”

Raguel babbled like a possessed man, words rolling off his tongue and tumbling over one another as if each and every one was more important than the last. The stream of words rose to a hysterical warble and Lot struggled abruptly to his hind paws, anxious that others would hear, that guards would come running. His friend: he had to protect his friend. He staggered forward, clapping his paws heavily on to the rabbit’s shoulders, thinking this would be enough to shock Raguel out of whatever spiel he was reeling off – more about getting Lot out of the prison. Lot drew Raguel bodily further into the cell, hoping against hope that his voice would not carry too far.

“Raguel!” Lot said sternly, raising his voice only enough to be heard over the rabbit’s crazed speech. “Listen to me. Quiet yourself!”

To his surprise, Raguel stuttered into quiet, looking from left to right as if he had only just realised where he was. Looking so bewildered and helpless, Lot wished that they could have been anywhere else but in the prison, just so he could see the life return to Raguel’s eyes. He had always been a bright fur, if one that he had never truly learned about, never taking the husband of his wife’s sister as a personal interest. Lot licked his dry lips, struck by the sudden urge to pull his friend into his arms and hold him closer than he had held his wife in many, many years, if ever.

“You have to leave now,” the canine rubbed Raguel’s shoulder, trying to say without words that he understood, though he was not sure if he even understood his own words. “What if the guards find you here? With me? Raguel, you know better than I what they would do to you. You would be a sinner, just like me.”

“But I came to rescue you.”

Raguel’s voice was pathetically small and Lot discovered himself tipping forward, barely catching himself as the movement started. Biting the inside of his cheek to conceal his discomfort and evident confusion – those cursed dreams had corrupted him – Lot tried to smile reassuringly, though his expression twisted into more of a grimace than anything else.

“Rescue me? Why would you, Raguel? I am not worth rescuing. I am not worth the life that I once had and abused. If you are caught...” Lot shuddered. “No, not for me, Raguel. Leave me.”

Sighing, Lot took a step back, drawing the rabbit with him. The action went against everything he had said only a second ago about wanting Raguel to leave, to not get caught, but he could not help himself. The rabbit's soft fur felt good beneath his fingers. Having donned a robe without sleeves, Raguel's svelte form was shown off to its best appeal, making him appear near regal in Lot's eyes.

"Where have you been, Raguel?" Lot asked, tone unexpectedly gentle.

The rabbit swung his muzzle from side to side like one of the sightless and made a strangled noise in his throat, words sticking.

"Does it matter?" His whiskers quivered. "I am here now and you do not desire my help anymore. It does not matter that I came for you, Lot, does it? Does it matter to you, my friend, that I came to help you?"

Lot shook his head and suppressed a sigh, tongue pressed to the roof of his mouth in a physical effort to keep himself in check. It would not do to frustrate Raguel further: the rabbit was far from being in his right mind. Tracing his tongue across his lower lip, Lot stepped closer to Raguel, bare fur brushing the rabbit's robe.

"No, Raguel." Lot ran his paw down Raguel's arm, feeling muscle tense and release beneath the bare fur. "That is not what I am asking and I am thankful for your care, that you thought of me. Where have you been? You certainly have not been staying at the inn."

"I could not go back to the inn, not after Edith was taken away and you disappeared."

Raguel forgot to mention Lot's daughters, he noted, but he could not hold the rabbit at fault for that.

"I never meant to come back."

Lo's tone was flat, recalling the haste in which he had left Sodom, seeing the fires that had never been justly explained. Had he really been such a fool as to expect someone to explain to a sinner? A law breaker? The laugh gurgled in his throat, desperate to escape as he was keen to keep it silent. The rabbit's ears slunk back over his shoulders, devoid of all life.

"I know." Raguel looked down between his hind paws. "Who would wish to return to Sodom, besides those that thrive here? You did your best for me but, if you are not leaving, it is perhaps due time that I did. That I left."

Lot looked at the rough, brown wall over Raguel's shoulder, imagining that he was staring into the distance. The white curve of the rabbit's shoulder became oddly sensual in the dim light and Lot rubbed his thumb through the fur, delighting subconsciously in the shiver he felt beneath his paw. Recklessness surged through the canine's blood, blazing fingers of heat trailing over his dirty fur until he feared he may see trails of smoke rising from his own body, a miracle and a horror all at once. As still as a statue, Lot stood with his fingers curled around Raguel's arm and shoulder respectively, unwilling to release his friend yet terrified inexplicably to do anything other than simply hold him. Raguel blinked, muzzle tilted down slightly as Lot stepped forward, closing the distance between them, leaving Raguel no window of opportunity in which to act.

Lot's lips pressed to Raguel's in a hasty, clumsy kiss. The canine's breath halted mid-breath and he closed his eyes, drawing a paralysed rabbit in closer than even his dreams had allowed. Oh, the dreams... It was better than his dreams. A soft murmur, unlike any sound that Lot had ever made before, passed his lips, travelling through a light hum into the muzzle of his shocked, static partner.

Raguel jolted.

"What is wrong with you?" Raguel shot back as if he had been stung, wiping the back of his paw across his muzzle. "Lot, you've become one of them!"

"Not in the slightest, friend."

Lot smiled, strength in his expression stolen from his weak legs. A breath of air could have toppled him over. Raguel shook his head, shifting anxiously from one hind paw to the other as he rocked back on his heels.

"You must come with me!" He declared, voice trembling. "We can put this to rights, Lot, please believe me. Please do not become like every other male and female in Sodom. Please do not leave me too."

The rabbit's breath hitched, the final words of his utterance caught in a strangled sob. He wrapped his arms around his torso in a manner of hug, drawing comfort from the act of being hugged, even if it was not quite what his frazzled mind desired. His arms were so cold that they could have belonged to another fur, almost. He could imagine.

"Quiet," Lot breathed, raising his paw to Raguel's cheek. "All shall be well. Allow me to do this for you, as a friend."

The rabbit jerked as if tugged by an invisible puppeteer's strings, muscles twitching without rhyme or reason. The Canaan dog trailed his paw down his friend's chest, fingertips bolder with every passing second, and curved his free paw around Raguel's waist, lightly preventing him from pulling away out of fear. He would never have restrained Raguel if he had truly wished to be elsewhere but the inescapable bulge in the rabbit's robes could not be construed as anything aside from the obvious.

Raguel flinched, raising his paws as if in protest yet, somehow, they landed upon Lot's chest and stayed there, the rabbit unable to find the will to pull away. Upbringing battled with desire and Raguel moaned lowly, ducking his head down against the larger canine's chest. Lot's mouth twisted and he stroked his friend's back gently, cheeks flushing as his own arousal became evident, tucked in against the rabbit's stomach: the space between them narrowed. Ears folded back, Raguel leaned into his friend, paws roaming to the canine's broad back, feeling himself dwarfed, though there was no great difference in their heights, only body mass.

Tilting Raguel's muzzle upwards, Lot's lips met his in a tender kiss. Perhaps he had wanted, beneath his prejudice and thwarted faith, to know Raguel so intimately for a longer stretch of time than previously imagined. But that notion was too cliché for his liking and he dismissed it in the next heartbeat, focusing on the warmth of the body pressed to his. It did not matter if

moments had been passed by, misplaced in the sinuous weave of time. Raguel was in his arms now and he would show his friend simply how much he meant to him. It was the least he could do.

He did not allow words time – the time they had was too little already. Night was passing as inevitably as it always would. Dropping a second kiss on the rabbit's lips, a fiery thrill raced through the dog's veins as Raguel responded, tentatively but unmistakably. Lot withdrew with a murmur, wishing to feel more, take joy in every fleeting second as it was presented to him. Yet he could not. He had another joy to deliver, something to one far more deserving than he.

Feeling the strain quiver upon his aged body, Lot slowly sank to his knees, going down on to first one and then the other, tattered robe hardly cushioning his limbs at all. The canine did not mind. It would only be uncomfortable for a time. The pleasure for Raguel would be worth any discomfort he felt. Raguel's nose twitched and he inhaled sharply as Lot's paw crept up his leg, smoothing the fur down as he went. When he reached the rabbit's loincloth, Raguel flinched, only prevented from leaping in shock by a gentle paw on his calf.

"Lot, what –"

"Quiet," Lot repeated once more, looking up at the rabbit as he knelt on the cold cell floor. "Let me do this for you."

Cut off so swiftly, Raguel could not argue and could not disagree. His wife had never done such for him. No, that would be a lie. Ansha had offered it to him, hesitantly, several times, in each instance appearing to have summoned up the courage over many days. He had denied her. The rabbit stiffened. He would not treat his wife so again. He would not lie to her. If he could only have her in her arms again.

None of that. Raguel closed his eyes and allowed his head to fall back, moonlight falling across his fur through the cell bars and that little, high window, woefully inadequate. Acutely aware of Lot stroking his thighs, ignoring the matted fur and massaging tired muscles, Raguel lightly dropped his paw to the back of Lot's neck, resting hardly any pressure there for fear of breaking the moment. His undergarments did nothing to conceal his arousal and the rabbit twisted uncomfortably, exposed to the point of vulnerability to be in such a state. Yet...he could not ask Lot to stop. Raguel shivered. He wanted what his friend had to offer.

Lot traced his short claws over the loincloth, trying to ensure Raguel was comfortable even as his heart pounded in his ears. Could Raguel hear it? Slipping his paw beneath, Lot freed the rabbit's flesh-coloured member. Wrapping his paw around the shaft, Lot wondered how long it had been since Raguel had experienced sexual pleasure. The whimpering moan somewhere above his head suggested an extended stretch of time and Lot resolved to ensure his friend enjoyed, though he must err on the side of gentleness. He could never forgive himself if he hurt Raguel, not even by accident.

Surprised by the eagerness in his own actions, Lot leaned forward, Raguel's paw on his neck moving with him, lapping over the head of the rabbit's member. A quick inhalation above told him that he was doing well, alongside the fingers curling into his scruff, and Lot strove to imagine what he would like in a similar situation, what his daughters and Esther had done for him. Mimicking the sweet vixen, Lot stroked down the length and curled his flexible

tongue around the shaft, treating the cock like a fine treat. Raguel's skin was salty from sweat and musky from the day and the trials he'd endured in reaching Lot's cell, but this only increased Lot's illicit enjoyment in the act. The taste made it real.

Raguel could not stop trembling, though not for lack of trying. His legs buckled at the knee and it took every ounce of concentration and twitching whiskers to hold himself upright, leaning on Lot's shoulder for support. He thought himself a fool for never accepting Ansha's offers in the past. It was not a mistake he would make twice.

Clumsily, the Canaan dog drew the rabbit's cock between his lips, sucking as he had seen females through Sodom doing, some in the very prison he resided within. They were not the shy sort and he strove to mimic their moves from shady memory, tongue lapping up the underside of the smooth shaft to draw soft, breathy gasps from Raguel's lips. The rabbit shifted his weight constantly as if he could not decide how or where to settle. Though he had mated with his wife as a male should in order to conceive a pup, it had been too long since he had experienced pleasure. Surely pleasure could not be so bad when it felt so good? Could it be a sin? Whimpering, Raguel clenched his teeth together as Lot pushed his muzzle down as far as he could on the rabbit's length.

Alas, the canine's skill was lacking and he convulsed in a cough, body jerking as he withdrew enough to take several steadying breaths, breathing through his nostrils. He sank down more carefully, stopping before the shaft hit the back of his throat and triggered his gag reflex. Comforting the dog with gentle strokes over his head, Raguel curled his fingers behind Lot's ears, eyes closed and lips parted as ecstasy mounted all too quickly. He recognised the high, both fearing and anticipating it with tremors in his stomach.

Lot bobbed his muzzle slowly along the rabbit's length, getting used to the taste and feel, stretching his jaws wide. Twitching and gasping, Raguel rolled his hips forward, allowing his length to slip a little deeper, ears slipping back so they flopped down against his skull, finally relaxing. Lot started as pre cum dripped from the tip – only a couple of drops, though he was unsure how much pre cum was normal for males, having only his own experience to go on – and lapped it up quickly, scooping the salty droplets into his muzzle with a soft murr. Above him, the rabbit was restless, hard cock throbbing as if he struggled to restrain himself from moving as he wished. Lot's jaw ached but he would not stop until he had given the rabbit the pleasure he deserved.

The rabbit's hips bucked against his will, paws resting on top of Lot's head, scratching lightly through his head fur. Working the rod deeper into his muzzle, Lot increased his pace, looking up at Raguel as he strove to drive the rabbit to climax. Raguel deserved far more than his clumsy attempts at oral, giving half the pleasure a skilled one could have supplied – anyone else would have been better than him. Screwing his eyes tightly shut, the rabbit breathed in short, sharp breaths, thrusting lightly into Lot's muzzle. The canine's lips sealed around Raguel's cock in a tight ring, stimulating him in such a way that the rabbit imagined that he was mounting Ansha once again, trying for a little pup with her eyes to call their own, a crossbreed that was perfect in every way.

He could not deny his most base desire to breed and extend his family, for the first time feeling no shame over the need rising in his chest. He ejaculated with a gasp, clutching on to Lot as if his life depended on it, as if he could only anchor himself in reality by holding on to

the canine tightly enough. Warmth flooded Lot's chest and, for the first time in years, something settled within him, soothing his addled mind.

They were quiet for several long moments once the rabbit climaxed, silence once again falling over the prison. The rabbit stroked his fingers shakily through the canine's hair, feeling the build up of dirt that made the canine more rugged than his usual dignified, pious self. Something had changed. The duo breathed in unison, pressed close as Raguel's cock softened and Lot sat back, letting it slip from his muzzle. It was too quiet to be believable and Lot was struck by the sudden fear that they were being listened to, observed. But that could not be true. There was no one there. Even the other inhabitants of the prison were peaceful, no longer turning and groaning through the night as they were apt to do.

Raguel sank to the floor, a dazed look in his eye. Taking a seat beside him, Lot drew the rabbit in close, comforting him from the extremes of emotions raging through his being. If he had not had the experience with his daughters and Esther, Lot did not doubt that he would be in the same state, having challenged the norms of his upbringing. He shivered. What was normal anymore? Nothing made sense and it was up to them to dictate their own futures, taking them where they would.

No, he could not do that, he remembered belatedly. Lot deflated visibly, ears drooping sadly. He squeezed his arm around Raguel, tracking a pattern on the wall scratched by some claw or knife some time ago. Had that individual been in distress too to leave such a mark upon the wall? Lot shuddered. He may be the next to leave scars in the stone in tribute to inner turmoil until the wear of weather, years and other bodies erased it from existence, as he would be if the citizens of Sodom had their way with him. Strangely, he was no longer afraid of them taking advantage of him in the sexual sense, which had been his original concern, but now feared for his very life and future.

"What do we do now, Lot?" Raguel whispered, his voice obscenely loud in the otherwise silence.

Outside, a bird cried out, something that neither of them could identify. Lot sighed. That was a very good question indeed. And he had no idea how he should or could answer.

"Have faith in the people of Sodom, Raguel," Lot said, stroking the rabbit's head with the gentleness of a lover. "They will set you on the right course."

Raguel trembled.

"And what of you, my friend? What becomes of you?"

His whiskers quivered, the rabbit appearing close to tears. Slowly, Lot shook his head, looking up at the moonlight glancing off the wall. Dawn would soon be upon them, another day and his fate to be decided.

"Justice will be served as they see fit to deliver.

*

Reunited with her daughters, Edith felt herself treated as if royalty. While more permanent accommodations were arranged, they had been given a large room in an inn near the centre of the city – a prime location for the busy individual looking to keep up with the pace of the city. Edith exhaled gently, relaxing back on a recliner, hind paws raised enough to take the soreness from them. She had spent too much time walking in the past months in her search for her daughters, her journey to Sodom and further back. Life outside Sodom seemed like a far cry from any life she had led before, so restricted. It was good to finally be able to relax in the knowledge that her little family was as safe and well as they could be.

It would have been better if her daughters' bellies were not swollen with pups, however, the thought of them bearing young from their father drawing the bitter taste of bile into her mouth.

She understood, of course, after due explanation, that Pheine and Thamma had instigated the deviancy. It was almost to be expected after their upbringing and sudden insertion into the life of Sodom. They had seen too much too swiftly to continue on without acting upon their baser urges. They were her blood, after all. They could not be blamed and, much to her grief, neither could Lot. Edith still wished nothing more than for the pups to belong to another fur, someone more deserving of Sodom.

Meals were served exactly as one desired in their inn and the three sat down around a low table to eat as a group, tasting local dishes with murmurs of approval. The round table was set about with brightly coloured cushions to perch upon and all three sat cross-legged, comfortable even with Pheine and Thamma's larger bellies. Clean water was supplied for every fur to drink and Edith did not deny her daughters the wine they sought, sipping from skins and clay pots until their cheeks warmed with the liquor. She was pleased to see that they drank of it with care and good sense, however, satisfied that she had brought her daughters up to learn when to indulge and when to restrain. It was the best she could give them.

Sated from the meal, the family rested in comfortable silence, allowing their food to digest while they picked at sweet treats and fine, rare fruits the kitchen servants brought forth for dessert, presenting them with paws raised and heads bowed. They had never had such time to simply spend relaxing prior to their time in Sodom: Lot had always disturbed them in one way or another even if they were never expected to complete any true 'work' as such. Work was for the servants when it came to that side. Edith smiled, content to find her family in such a good position.

Edith started as a hand-claw dropped lightly to her shoulder, drawing her attention from the flickering lamp, flame burned almost down to the wick.

"Would you like to adjourn to the baths now, my ladies?" The innkeeper, a Demoiselle crane with a solemn, black head, gestured away from the table, beckoning them to follow. "You may find it pleasant to bathe with a full stomach and take your leave to the bed chambers as you please."

"Thank you."

Pheine smiled up at the crane, eyes travelling down the line where black and white feathers joined. Red feathers surrounded his eyes in a thin line, drawn to the back of his head where a

tiny trail of feathers drooped down from his head. He looked distinguished. There did not seem to be many birds around Sodom – they usually appeared to prefer making their own flocks and, in the case of migratory species, travelling from town to city, never remaining in one location for too long.

They did not need to disrobe when they reached the inn's baths, having remained naked throughout their meal. It was more comfortable, Edith had found, when in personal company. She would not go out on the streets of Sodom without some cloth covering her body, but that was more as protection from the day's sun and night's cold than anything else. She was far from ashamed of her body and those bodies belonging to her beautiful, glowing daughters.

The baths were suited to the size of the inn and entirely private: only guests of the inn itself were permitted into the establishment, setting it apart from the public. This was not for bodily privacy, however, but rather to provide its users a more luxurious experience. Slaves and servants dotted the large, main pool, which was of a comfortable temperature for bathing, and the smaller 'plunge' pools, intended to shock the body into a greater sense of refreshment. Edith's tail wagged. It was good to have the luxury of looking after one's health as the healers insisted they do. It was not something one could do on the road and she was tired of moving, walking, from place to place. She would quite happily stay in Sodom for as long as her daughters desired.

Thamma relaxed into the warm pool of water, shoulders resting against the natural stone rim. One would not slip on the stone floor, which was roughed up slightly for grip, and, considering the pups in her belly, she was thankful for this. More than once since falling pregnant, the Canaan dog had found herself off-balance, her centre of gravity altered with her growth, and at risk of taking a nasty tumble. Pheine had had the same problem but, perhaps due to the difference between their bodily shapes, had had less difficulty with this part of pregnancy. Raising her arms for the attending bathing slave, identified by the circlet of metal around her neck, Thamma luxuriated in being washed, her pups squirming in her belly. She felt blessed that she would soon have them in her arms, canines possessing a shorter gestation period than most species.

She wondered if she would have more pups later, or if she would hold only her first litter. It was something that she needed to consider but a thought that Pheine had dismissed with a flick of her paw.

There are servants to care for pups, Pheine had said, returning to her meal that previous night. *We are there to raise them to be good individuals, to teach them about the world. It is the base needs that you and I do not need to consider that will go to the servants. You will want another litter, I trust you will.*

Fact was that Thamma understood at long last that breeding or not was entirely her choice. It was not for Pheine to decide. The decision could be postponed, however, and was not something immediate that required a decision either way. Only she would need to think about ways in which to explore herself further without immediately falling pregnant before she had made the choice. The canine shook her head, the tiniest frown catching at the corners of her lips. She needed to look after her unborn pups first of all, suckle them at her breasts. Dreaming of a happier time to come, Thamma dozed off in the bath, slaves attending to every nuance of her body with silken cloths and sponges.

When they were contently bathed and smelling faintly of fresh oils, the three furs roused themselves from the baths, aided from the water by the servants and slaves, each drawing them up with strong muscles. Settled on two hind paws upon the rough, sandy stone, Edith resisted the urge to shake out her fur and looked slyly to her daughters, checking that both were safe and well. It was difficult to trust in their wellbeing when they had only so recently been snatched away from her without rhyme or reason. And now she had their pups to take into consideration also, complicating the matter of safety further.

The servants would have approached with drying cloths at that point but were stalled by the innkeeper who held up one clawed hand to stall them, beak parted as if he was about to launch into conversation. Politely, all waited on him, Edith's eyebrows raised expectantly: she hated to be kept cold and waiting when there was no need.

"My ladies," the innkeeper smiled genially, taking an appreciative look over Edith's body, the older canine closest in age to him. "I have a special event for you to partake in, if this is something you would enjoy at this time."

He cast his eyes over Pheine and Thamma's bellies, clearing noting that his hesitation was because of their pregnancy and not due to their comfort. From a doorway set into the rear of the bathing chamber appeared several mammalian anthros, none of whom wore slave collars – so servants. Pheine counted them, her eyes wide. In total there stood two horses, an ibex, another Canaan dog, some manner of rodent and a leopard. All were native species, frequently found within Sodom, but the group held themselves with such poise and attention that Pheine could never have simply walked by them on the street. One would have been tempted to stop and stare at their grace and delicate strength. All, of course, were male.

The crane tilted his head, watching their reactions with a keen eye.

"It is an initiation of sorts," he chuckled lightly, raising his arm to beckon an ibex closer, wing extended. "Take your fill of my servants of pleasure. They have been informed of your situation and you may do as suits you best with them. They could dry you, to begin with, massage – which may be pleasant for our two, lovely blossoms – and do more if you feel up to his."

He gave a conspirator's wink, unnecessary to the truly initiated.

"I hear they are highly skilled in delivering female pleasure."

Looking the males up and down with a critical eye, Edith took the lead, stalking forward at a quick clip. Taking the Canaan dog as her example, she ran her paws down his bare chest, feeling the soft, cream-coloured fur. It slipped beneath her fingers like the finest silk and Edith sighed. If only she had married a Canaan dog like this one, though she could say nothing of his nature without knowing him personally. In physique, however, he was a far cry from her husband and even her teasing touch had roused him to a state, length sliding from his sheath as he shuffled and gave her a smile that could not be too sheepish.

Leaning in to give the canine a quick kiss on the nose – she had to stand on her toes to reach him – Edith giggled like a much younger canine, spinning about to face her daughters, who appeared surprised at her forwardness in the moment. She forgot that they had not seen her fresh ideas and take on life, bar the nudity. For a moment, she wondered if it was sensible to

be so forward in front of her daughters, old thoughts seeping in through the cracks, but she brushed the notion aside. Pheine and Thamma were grown and with pup. It was better that she show them more of the joys of sexuality than restricted them, opening her daughters up to abuse.

Edith licked her lips, eyes straying back to the servants, shifting their weight and looking to one another as if they were just as eager as she to begin.

“We should not miss an opportunity to become better acquainted with the customs of Sodom,” Edith nodded, lips tugging up at the corners. “It would be rude not to.”

“Of course,” the crane chuckled.

Turning on his heel, the crane left them to their selections, shaking his head at the jest of those females, how swiftly they had found themselves entwined in the arms of Sodom.

They belonged to the city as much as any natural citizen of Sodom.

*

Moonlight struck the sand a short, five minutes or so, walk from Malachi’s inn. A public latrine was set up for common folk such as Esther to use: they made do. It was rarely used at such an hour. Desiccated by day through the burning sun, at night it assumed a cooler vacancy on the edge of the city. The darkness purified as baked waste, which was normally visible, was concealed. The only notion that there something unwholesome resided there was the muted outlines showing under the miniscule lux.

Esther valued her solitude and it was uneventful for her to visit the latrines so late when a private one was not available. She tried to visit when they were empty during daylight hours, if at all possible, but sometimes one’s bodily functions must be stomached for the sake of secrecy. They were too open otherwise. Though the Malachi’s inn boasted a private rest area, it was off limits for all but the most distinguished guests. Esther sighed, thinking momentarily of the most recent guests as a tall caracal approached the open latrines, shuffling in beside her to a squat. Conversely, Esther propelled her body upwards, allowing her dress to plume around her legs in a cascade of fabric. The gape between her thighs would have revealed her sex if she had not covered herself so carefully with the dress and, fearing discovery from the caracal, rose fluidly, her business complete. She trailed away, heading from the inn and deeper into the heart of the city.

The evening was the only time when the city assumed an omnipresent scent. The heat of the day stripped fragrance from the air, anything pleasant rising into the ethers. She inhaled slowly, taking in the aroma with a soft sigh. It was a curious mixture of the pungency of mammalian excrement, which eased as she paced further from the latrine, alongside aromatic consequences of copulation and simmering charcoal. It was the antithesis of loneliness, if she could put it so simply, perfectly. The city and scents were alive, yet not overwhelming in their ideal balance, suited to the temperature.

She strolled back into the city, passing the quarters of those with great potential in the city: immature slaves for use in the bedchamber. The purpose of the mud hut housing the slaves was concealed from visitors, though there were few visitors other than merchants in the city,

if truth was told. Despite being housed by one of the public latrines, the citizens of Sodom referred to it as an orphanage. The name was not inaccurate. It had become the regular dumping ground for wayward young who were abandoned or inexcusably parentless from nearby conflicts, scooped up by shrewd traffickers en route to the city. They were the lost souls. Every pleasure slave bred within the city was descended from a parent whose childhood was spent there. No other beings from the outside world were known to enter the city upon any regularity, bar the merchants, whose wares were much appreciated. The carnal activities of the city were shocking to most, repulsive to some. It was better to breed and tame pleasure slaves from as young an age as possible for the best chance at compliance.

The slaves, spared some ignominy, were only sold into the public realm once they had matured, according to law. Esther occasionally heard rumours about the slaves but did not pay a great deal of attention to them, though it was curious what was noted about the high value youngsters. Some were captured under illicit conditions, more akin to kidnapping. It would not surprise Esther if the rumours were true, yet she still felt that Sodom was one of the safest and orderly cities she had ever set paw in. It was a place, however, that one could obtain anything with the right words, connections and coin. It boasted a hierarchy of lawfulness, which evaporated when gold was wielded by a patron, but its foundations were, at least, robust.

Esther shuddered, pausing to look at the building with a keener eye. Would her life have been like that if Malachi had never found her as a kit? The vixen closed her eyes, shivering, though she told herself that it was the night chill. It would probably have been worse.

If she had been a slave, her identity would never have become such, morphing as she grew. She found the trade of Sodom, in slaves, objectionable if not downright distasteful, but knew that the surrounding cities put slaves to work in agriculture. It was not uncommon to hear of young slaves in other cities being worked to early deaths, a frightening truth. The recent fall of the Mesopotamian empire at the hands of the west led to an abundance of expendable young souls. Life held little value any longer.

The orphanage, from the exterior, could have been benevolent, and the young treated with enough kindness so that they would not attempt escape. Esther wondered if those slaves experienced their first sexual experiences like she had, in confusion and drunkenness? Like she had in the cave with the two sisters and their father? She did not know how to feel about the experience. Traumatized? She felt the same, if confused. It was what brought her to wondering if freshly sold and bedded slaves could empathise with her experience. She was little more than a tool in their play, if a well cared for, pleased tool. Were slaves passed around family members as well? She could only assume it was true. Servants, after all, cared for all members of the household. Why should slaves be any different?

Of course, Esther had not impregnated Pheine and Thamma – there could be no question about that. Even so a kit knew how difficult it was to breed between two different species'. She could not recall a known instance in which a fox's seed fathered a canine pup. Esther understood this: she indefinitely listened. It was only appropriate that others would reveal themselves while she sequestered away, soaking in their actualities and perceptions. From this, she garnered much of what was and was not possible with individual sexual organs; citizens of Sodom spoke freely about these topics, no holds barred. Further, Esther believed it would be near impossible for her to father a kit with how little semen she produced upon orgasm: a welcome side effect of the herbs she consumed.

So both the impish sisters were naturally brimming with their father's pups – disgraceful for dogs of their status! Esther's nose wrinkled and she withheld a sneeze. It seemed wrong for family to liaise, though pleasure slaves were commonly bred to family members to yield the most licentious individual. The crown prize would fetch the highest price. Shaking her head, Esther carefully brushed back the fur on her muzzle, focusing on the action to the exclusion of all else. A shameless litter of pups. Surely Pheine and Thamma would hatch something just as beastly! Whatever dropped from the older sister's womb would be especially ghastly in lust, Esther speculated, as the liaison was mostly down to her alone.

She continued onward, the orphanage to her back, paws folded neatly over her stomach. A fire nearby smouldered and the vixen's ears swivelled to catch the sound, wood and kindling crackling in death. Beneath the pops of the embers, the husky breaths of a female enticed the vixen closer against her better judgement. She approached quietly, not wishing to startle the female. Voyeurism was commonplace in the city and welcomed as long as one did not interfere. The vixen's billowy tail rose and fell with her steps and, as she drew near, the scene assembled from the darkness.

A female onager – horse-like and commonly referred to as an Asian Wild Ass – with lidded eyes lay on a cart of hay, ankles and wrists tied with rope so that her legs were splayed open. The raspy tongue of a male sand cat ground against her clit and her legs twitched every few seconds, lips parted in feminine needs. Another onager stood behind the cart, stroking his hard, pink cock rapidly as if preparing for the grand event, spilling his seed over her muzzle. A symbol branded the sand cat, though it was not one Esther recognised. It could have branded him as a slave of either one of them. It was unimportant. The equine acknowledged the vixen with a tenuous look, shifting his gaze back to the eyes of his female partner.

“Would you not like to show this vixen what a whore you are, my little pet?”

The onager opened her eyes, darting momentarily back and forth until they landed on Esther's moonlit silhouette. Their full size and icy cerulean colour captured the luminosity of the moon, striking Esther with such force that she took a step back. Her eyes opened almost impossibly wide, desperate and eager, edges accentuated by ash to white the sclera around the iris. Even in the darkness, they were incandescent, and conscious thought dissipated from the vixen while those eyes locked upon her. A moment later, the onager's head whipped around, staring up at her partner. Esther took a breath, released from their grip.

“Y-yes, yes, please, oh,” the onager groaned, chest shaking in her excitement.

The vixen took this as invitation and moved within arm's length of the cart. The onager's body was beautiful, white fur lining her belly, breasts and inner thighs. The area between her legs was coated with a dusted plume of trimmed dirty-blond fur, evidence of her youthfulness. Her breasts were small and rose to a point, nipples a pale pink that perked youthfully. Despite her young maturity, she was by no means slender, and her hips were full and elliptic, thighs fleshy, and abdomen briskly rotund. The fur on the top of her head was a fiery red, thick and wickedly curled. Beside her, the equine was stood strikingly, delicately curved and with barely any muscle. It was a peculiar smoothness for a male, feminine in contrast to his solid, strong-jawed face. The female quivered beneath him as their eyes locked.

“You like being watched, slut?” He hissed between his teeth. “Wouldn’t you love it if I blindfolded you and woke up a few of the locals just so they could come out and fuck you?”

“Mmmph,” she moaned, biting her lip as her face flushed pink beneath the white edges of her fur.

Esther licked her lips, watching.

“Wouldn’t you love to be treated like a piece of furniture?” The equine grew more crazed in his motions, paw pumping his length. “You want to be fucked by a bunch of males you’ve never met, feel them thrust and spill their warm seed in you.”

Her hips twitched up against the slave’s tongue, convulsing in a way that was alien to that of the two sisters the vixen had recently fucked or many of the other females she’d previously watched. Esther had never seen anything of the sort. Parting her lips, the onager’s breath became ragged and disorganized as fits surged through her lower body, muzzle twisting with pleasure. Esther stared at her face, caught by her expression. The male grunted, exchanging a look of ferocity with his partner, hips bucking forward.

“I’m sure you would love if your friends and family walked in on you afterwards too,” he whispered, cock drooling pre cum over her muzzle. “Cum spilling out of every orifice, body ravaged as you begged them not to look, your family not to see you loving every single second... Humiliation like that you would endure.”

He paused, as if something minute fell into his thoughts, detonating a moment later. Whatever it was seemed to rip him out of the scene and made him, for a few seconds, lose his focus. The barren expression on his muzzle tore at the vixen’s heart. What had happened in that instance? One would never know. His hand flailed against his thick member, trying to get himself back on track. The onager was oblivious below him, gasping for air, eyes widening to reveal their luster.

“D-don’t stop, keep talking! Please keep talking!” she shouted, desperate to reach her peak.

The male’s expression fell into melancholy, darkening outwards from his eyes. Then, as if he had been mentally scrambling to discover traction, he bit down on his lower lip and screamed.

“You fucking whore! You would suck off your own father if it meant you’d get some cum out of it! I bet you loved eating out my asshole right after you met me the other night!”

Spittle flew from his mouth, the equine crazed and frothing.

“Your cunt must have been dripping wet, dying to feel something, *anything* inside it again. It had been too long, had it not? A day or so without a fuck? You cannot go that long without a cock. Is that not right? Do you want everyone to know how disgusting you are, how you love to have any male – anyone at all – come up to you and fuck you anyway they please, just for his own satisfaction? Do you want everyone to know that you lost your virginity to someone whose name you can’t even remember?”

The onager squirmed, eyes closed.

“Yes, oh, I do want that, I do want them to know,” the onager hissed through clenched teeth. “The filthy little slut-mare I am.”

Her final words and her partner’s goading thrust her beyond climax, body twisting in pleasure. Convulsions wracked her body, beyond her control, and the cart creaked as she whipped against it like a creature possessed, thrown about by her body like a toy. The brutality of her orgasm was remarkable and the stallion moaned out his climax above her, painting her muzzle with thick streams of seed. He poured forth an impressive volume, innumerable pulses bursting from his shaft in a display of equine virility. When the rush finally ended, he reached down, tentatively stroking a paw through his partner’s hair as she struggled to breathe normally once more.

Esther stopped, mystified. Why had the equine stopped so suddenly in the middle of sex? A sickening feeling in the pit of her stomach told her the answer that she did not want to hear, too close to her own experience for comfort. Where he had lost concentration, Esther had witnessed his heart fracture, an irreparable crack rending it down the centre. Why? The equine had been used, it was so simple. The onager turned her head away, looking down at the sand cat between her legs, gently cleaning her inner thighs of her own sexual fluids. Her partner was already forgotten, standing over her with ears drooping.

Esther collapsed into the sand, breathing heavily on her paws and knees as she struggled to compose herself. The sable earth beneath her paws was comforting, familiar, but not enough. Tears welled up in her eyes and she blinked them away the best she could. She may as well have been in the horse’s position, lost in aftermath and driven to blindness by a lifetime’s worth of physical desolation.

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In the inn baths, the older Canaan dog drew herself up tall. The only ones left in the bathing chamber were her daughters, herself and the servants, waiting expectantly. Pheine crossed her arms over her chest and tapped on hind paw against the floor, stone rough beneath her more sensitive paw pads. The Canaan dog was getting soft, but that did not necessarily seem like a bad thing.

“You and you,” Edith flicked her fingers towards two of the males in turn, not expending more energy in the motion than necessary. “Step forward to me.”

The leopard and the Canaan dog stepped forward. The feline’s tail swished expectantly and Edith smiled, lifting her paw to brush his cheek gently. Oh, how she enjoyed having her pick of males when it came to personal care and attention.

“Dry me thoroughly,” she instructed with a wink that could not be missed. “And take care not to miss a single spot.”

The canine had the decency to appear abashed briefly, cheeks colouring with emotion. The leopard retrieved two large cloths and passed another to his canine companion. A slight shiver of discomfort brought goose bumps on Edith’s skin and the Canaan dog shifted her weight as they began to dry her, the leopard beginning with her back and the dog kneeling to take care of her legs. With one on either side, she felt unduly exposed, though she had been

dried many times before at various baths throughout the city – however, she had paid for the privilege those times. The older Canaan dog shook herself and strove to relax, rolling her shoulders. She should not be so self-conscious in front of her daughters, but it was difficult to forget the years she had spent with them and her husband, the attitude she had adopted.

The remaining servants split between the daughters, taking soft cloth to their body. When one became saturated with water – thicker fur soaked up enough to wear out several cloths in a few minutes – it was placed aside in lieu of another, fresh one. Pheine gave a soft sound of appreciation as the cloth was gently moved over her belly, pups moving within. She closed her eyes, lips parted in a momentary daydream, imagining her future with her young. What could she teach them? She would ensure they had only the best and nothing but the best. This sort of luxury should be experienced by them on a daily basis.

Thamma tensed as she allowed the ibex to dry her, fingers itching to take the act of drying into her own paws. It was strange to be so pampered and even frequent baths were not something they had usually took part in except for special occasions. Glancing at her mother, she slid her gaze away a moment later as the horse servant dried her breasts, paws soft through the cloth as he caressed each round globe, nipples inadvertently rising into peaks. Embarrassed by her arousal, Thamma looked down between her legs, drifting into her own thoughts. It would have been easier to bear if the males surrounding her were less...handsome. She thought that was the proper word. Perhaps in the ideal manner of bath servants, they were chiselled and cut as if they spent the majority of their time working on their bodies all for the pleasure of visitors.

Thamma appreciated that.

Unaware of the awkwardness hanging in the quiet room, Pheine huffed quietly, head falling back as her hair was lifted from her neck for drying. The rodent – a petite brown male with a long, pink tail – twitched his whiskers, paws running down either side of Pheine's body without any fabric between them. His claws lightly scratched through her fur and she shivered in delight, tail wagging in a very visual reminder of her enjoyment. She felt her pussy moistening with her arousal, the scent barely noticeable over the warm, scented air of the baths. The cloth moved over her buttocks and she shamelessly arched into the pressure, feeling how her deliciously full body was so massaged. No one else was there to see how much she loved to be touched. Well, no one beside her family. She couldn't feel embarrassed in front of them, could she?

"My dearest Pheine," the rodent spoke up with a soft smile. "Would you like to adjourn to a more private room?"

The older Canaan dog pricked her ears, natural defensiveness of her daughter flickering into life.

"What more does the innkeeper have planned for us?" Edith asked.

Her fur was fluffy with most of the moisture removed, leaving her appearing larger than normal in her drying state. The servant looked up, his expression keen and earnest as his bright eyes shone.

“A massage.” The rodent bowed respectfully. “We have been taught the art of massaging females who are carrying young so that we may best please you.”

Edith raised an eyebrow, looking down at her noticeably flatter belly, only her natural curves giving rise to the area. The rodent took a moment to catch up with the words he had just uttered and then jumped as if he had been shocked right in the tail.

“Not to imply that we would not be skilled in any and all massage,” he added swiftly, taking a hasty step back. “We were simply given special instruction in the case of your daughters!”

Looking from side to side, the rodent servant appeared to wish to shrink into the ground itself. One of the other servants – nobody saw which – snickered under his breath, amusement getting the better of him. Pheine cocked her head, paw cupping her own cheek as she covered her smile politely.

“There is nothing untoward going on here, mother,” Pheine chuckled softly. “Do not tease him further. Please, let us take part.”

It was not a plea to be allowed but a statement from a confident young adult that knew exactly what she wanted. Mostly dry, the youngest sister followed the rodent towards the back of the baths where a wooden door was set in the wall, finding that she had no cause to delay. The massage sounded delightful. Thamma followed a moment later upon her heels, the remainder of the servants taking up a short procession behind her. Edith momentarily bristled, imagining that they had their eyes fixed to her daughter’s bare behind, but pulled herself up. That was not something she had to concern herself with anymore. There was nothing wrong with her daughter’s nudity.

Old habits died hard.

Hearts fluttering against ribcages, the trio entered the room upon much encouragement and waving of paws. The Canaan dog in particular seemed keen to usher them in, paws darting forward to stroke down Pheine’s back and side when Edith’s back was turned. She cast him a sultry look back over her shoulder and he licked his lips, ears slipping submissively to the either side of his skull. What would he give to have his muzzle buried between those beautiful thighs? If he was lucky, the lovely female would choose him.

Three padded tables had been placed in the room, set at approximately waist height. Made of wood, they were moveable and gave the appearance of being something that was frequently shifted throughout the inn. They were clearly massage tables and Edith gave a low murmur of appreciation, clasping her paws to her chest as she wondered if they would give private massages in the guest rooms. Depending on how good the servants proved to be at soothing her body, she would pay dearly for that manner of attention.

“Please, lay down,” the rodent said, gesturing to the nearest of the massage tables, paw sweeping out in an arc to encompass the room.

Pheine’s tail twitched.

“I, for one, need no further encouragement here!” She grimaced and hopped awkwardly on the table, careful of her bulging stomach. “My back *aches*. Can one of you tend to that?”

“Of course.” It was the Canaan dog that answered swiftly – too quickly for his eagerness to remain concealed, if it ever was in the first place. “Please, make yourself comfortable.”

Moving slowly due to her size, she scooted down on to her side, lying with her back to the long side of the table. It was wide enough that she could half-curl her legs up comfortably, drawing them up as if to hug them to her chest but her stomach was in the way. She was vaguely aware of her mother and sister perching upon the tables in her peripheral vision, however she found there were far more interesting things to focus upon.

The male Canaan dog rubbed the palms of his paws together, warming them with the friction. He paused, paws half-raised, and then stepped forward, stroking slowly down the length of Pheine’s body from her shoulder to her hip. The canine shivered and relaxed under his touch, one paw resting protectively upon her belly. It was good to have some personal attention, something just for her. With all the attention upon the ‘terrible’ things that had happened to her and the future of her pups, it sometimes felt as if she had been left by the wayside as life scurried on, towing only part of her with it.

Sitting upon their respective tables, Thamma and Edith enjoyed the same attention. Two furs worked upon Thamma as she dangled her legs over the edge of the table: the rodent massaged and rubbed her hind paws until she quivered while the other, an ibex, worked his way up her back to her shoulders. Relaxing into the shoulder massage, Thamma moaned softly and closed her eyes, muzzle open to allow her tongue to loll out. The ibex pressed lightly between her shoulder blades, slowly increasing the pressure until the tissue softened beneath his paws, hoof-like fingertips tracing light circles over Thamma’s short coat of fur. It was heavenly.

Without the restrictions of her daughters, Edith stretched out on her stomach, legs propped up on the table behind her. Taking full advantage of the remaining servants, she beckoned the two horses and leopard closer, admiring the leopard’s rosette spots through half-lidded eyes. He was a beautiful specimen, small and lithe as if he could spring into a long-legged spring at any given moment. The bay Arabian horse took up position at her legs, massaging down in long, languid strokes that made her shiver and sink deeper into the padding of the table. Her second horse, the stunning black, worked on her back and shoulders, easing out each and every knot of tension until she murmured incoherently, words of praise spilling forth that could not be individually discerned.

The leopard though was by far the most divine. Teasing his fingers through her hair, he whispered softly to the enthralled canine as he worked his magic upon her, massaging her scalp. She had had no idea that that kind of massage could be so...erotic.

Stretched out on the table, the youngest daughter squirmed and moaned, pups wriggling in her stomach. The canine worked out all the knots he was able to reach with Pheine lying on her side, toes flexing in the essence of relaxation as her eyes closed halfway. But the Canaan dog grew agitated and the strokes of his paws came quicker, digging lightly into the muscle so that Pheine arched, cupped her heaving stomach and groaned. He bit his lip, limited in what pleasure he could give her and he leaned in close, one paw resting ever so lightly upon her thigh, stroking small circles into her fur.

“I need to reach your back, Pheine,” he murmured into her ear, his whiskery muzzle brushing over her hair.

The canine cocked her head and rolled over on her back, belly huge and round. She groaned: her back ached something ferocious. Where were the Canaan dog's paws? He should soothe her.

There had been a question. Pheine shook her head and splayed one paw flat on the massage table as her mother and sister pricked their ears, listening intently but for different reasons.

"How?" She frowned. "I cannot rest on my stomach any more. It is far too uncomfortable."

"Oh, that is quite simple."

The Canaan dog took a step closer to the table, further down the long side, and rested his paw upon the padding. To Pheine's surprise, the table bowed in at the middle where he placed his paw and he pushed further down so that his paw disappeared up to the right. Pleased, he stepped back and folded his paws behind his pack, tail wagging. He was every inch the picture of a pleased canine.

"These have been specially designed for you, Pheine, and Thamma," he added, glancing with a respectful nod in the elder sister's direction. "Your pups will be safe and you will not be awkwardly placed in our paws. Edith, yours is unaltered. I am confident that you will be comfortable and best placed for us to please you."

Pheine grinned, the flash of white canines startling in the moment. They really had thought of everything. She flushed with approval and followed the canine's direction, slipping round on to her front and allowing her belly to fit comfortably into the hollowed out gap beneath the padding. Lying on the edge of the table as she had been, she had not even noticed it, it was so well constructed. Oh, how she had missed these little luxuries, the finer nuances of life! A massage table suited for her growing line was the very least of it, she thought.

Able to work on the canine as he truly wished, the Canaan dog swept the palms of his paws down her back, tracing the curve of her spine with one fingertip. Pheine shuddered and melted into the table, tail swishing from side to side in a constant wag that betrayed her enjoyment in a very canine fashion. Following the lead of her sister, Thamma took up a similar position on her massage table, permitting the rodent and ibex to work on the full length of her body. Paying particular attention to her calves and thighs, the ibex smiled to himself as he worked.

Teasing paws edging ever closer to Pheine's pussy, he swallowed his excitement, almost able to feel the heat radiating from her sex as he stroked the underside of her tail. His fingers combed through the soft fur and Pheine twisted, arching up as much as she was able in her position and condition.

"May I?" He nuzzled the back of her neck softly, lips brushing aside her hair in the gentlest of kisses.

Servants: "...there stood two horses, an ibex, another Canaan dog, some manner of rodent and a leopard."

The male servants direct the women to bedded stone tables and have them lay down, then anoint them with aromatic oils and proceed to massage them all over their bodies. Late into the massage, Pheine is the first to be prompted to get on her knees by her male servant tugging lightly on her hips. Pheine, being adventurous (and horny), obliges. Thamma and Edith, both who were still being massaged without erotic attention and have their eyes closed, become aware of Pheine only as she begins moaning. Turning to her, shocked, they see that the servant is performing cunnilingus on her while holding her tail up with one paw. The other servants direct Thamma and Edith up onto their knees; Thamma looks to her mother with protest, and Edith begins a remark but fails to finish it as the paw of the servant snakes to the interior of her thighs. Pheine becomes aware of the anxiety of her mother and sister beside her, and insists that the gentlemen are professionals and only performing their prescribed work. Edith attempts to speak again, but is cut off when a finger enters her vagina. Relenting, their mother picks herself up onto her knees and allows the servant to orally pleasure her. Taking her cue from her mother, although still with trepidation as she herself seemed nervous, Thamma also rises to her knees and allows herself to be pleased by the servant's tongue. After a thorough licking and rimming, the servants walk to the side of the women and remove their loincloths to reveal their erect penises.

As if obeying an unspoken order, all males stepped back as one, forming a single line, all facing the panting females. Still coming down from an explosive orgasm, Edith, trembled on the edge of the massage table, feeling that she needed a second bath after such erotic action. She did not understand why they had suddenly backed away as if to call a halt to their liaison and rather craved her male partner back between her legs. It was a hasty addiction and she tried to forget the fact that she had shared the sexual pleasure, if not directly, with her daughters.

Removing their loincloths, the males stood quite still, growing hard and erect as if on cue. The Canaan dog in particular bore an expression of intense concentration, tongue protruding ever so slightly from the corner of his mouth. Edith stifled a chuckle and shook her head: she could only assume that they were thinking of incredibly sexual scenes, arousing themselves through memory and fantasy alone. Though the ibex' paws twitched, the servants stood quiet, as if becoming statues, chests rising and falling gently in time. Blinking, Thamma looked between her younger sister and her mother, none able to fathom why the males had suddenly backed away and displayed themselves so. They did not seem eager to explain themselves either.

"What is the meaning of this?" Edith spoke up first, head tilted to one side, appearing for a second the spitting image of Pheine.

"I am unsure." Thamma shrugged. "This is not something I have come across in my time here. You have been in the city longer than my sister and I, mother. You would know more than us."

The Arab stallion parted his lips as if to answer when a muted gasp from Pheine bade him stop, dropping his eyes to the wooden floor of the massage room while a small smile warmed them.

“Oh!” Pheine clapped her paws together, excited at being the first to uncover the truth as she saw it. “I have it. I know. It’s so simple. The servants have given us oral pleasure so far, yes?”

Thamma and Edith nodded, though there was no clarity in their eyes.

“They are presenting themselves to us so that we may decide whether they are suitable for our use,” Pheine explained. “They are ensuring that their shafts are prime for us and, if so, allowing us to choose who our partner or partners will be. Whichever we prefer. Is that not correct?”

She addressed the horse and he bobbed his muzzle once, eyes bright with warmth. She reached out to his dropped horse-cock and pulled it down once, letting it bounce back up almost comically. The canine chuckled to herself and wrapped her paw around the length, stroking several times in quick succession, spurred on by his eager nicker. His ears drooped sadly when she paused, turning to the other two with a curiously raised eyebrow. Licking her lips, Pheine pulled her paw away, laying flat on the massage table with her elbows propped under her chest, so that she would not be squashed down uncomfortably.

“As I was the first to be eaten out,” Pheine began, a tell-tale glimmer of glee in her eyes, “someone else should be brave this time. I would be,” she added, “but I should not steal *all* the firsts and *all* the fun now, should I?”

“What do you mean?” Thamma shook her head. “Pheine, you speak in riddles.”

“Then you should understand me better,” her sister quipped in return. “I am saying, dear sister, that someone else needs to be the brave dog this time and be serviced by one or more of these studs and their cocks.”

Thamma wriggled on to her back and barked a laugh, amused by her sister’s forwardness. It was not that she did not *want* to mate with any of the studs – their muzzles had been delicious, it had to be said – but in front of her mother? Edith’s presence was the only thing that stopped her from slipping off the massage table and into the arms of whichever fur caught her first. Pregnancy raised lust in her that she had never known and she wormed a paw between her legs, fingers pushing into the dripping mess of her sex. It was so tempting to go further, to do more, but she still craved the approval of her mother. Anxious, Thamma withdrew her fingers from her folds and splayed her paw flat on her lower stomach, two fingers stained creamy white with her desire.

Edith faced a dilemma all of her own. The males lined up so insistently and all she could think of was her first night in Sodom, being taken by male after male, orgasm after orgasm. She could never remember exactly how many times she had climaxed that night – it all blended into one great haze of pleasure – but her clit throbbed for the same attention. The older Canaan dog sat up on the bench and swung her legs over the side, hesitating in the moment.

Much like Thamma, her eyes flicked between the row of waiting males, so virile at their peak of life, and her daughters, catching the tail end of Thamma’s need with a twinge of regret. She had felt the same when she was pregnant with Thamma, wanting to fuck anything and everything that came within reach. She had reached out to lot, presented to him in their

shared bed chamber, but he had balked at the suggestion, shouting to the lord and everyone within earshot that mating was for the purpose of *pups only* and a heavily pregnant female had no purpose for sex. She had not tried again when carrying Pheine. The second daughter smirked at her mother and Edith frowned, half raising a paw to reprimand her. That pup could use some respect for her elders.

Only, Pheine was no longer a pup. She was a grown canine preparing to birth her first litter of pups. Edith sighed. She would do well to remember that.

And if her daughters were all grown up, there was no shame in what she craved. The very least she could do for them was allow them to sate the lusts of pregnancy, allow them what their bodies desired so. She slipped off the table and padded to the ibex, trailing her fingers from the base of his cock to the tip. Her heart pounded in her chest with such force that she feared it would burst through, spilling through her fur in a rush of blood. Careful of her knees on the hard floor, she folded to her knees, toes pressed to the floor behind so that her calves formed a wonderful arch. Though not the slimmest of furs, she was proud of her body and curves: every female should love their body.

Edith ignored the soft gasp behind her, unsure which daughter had been so surprised in the moment, and leaned forward, lapping lightly over the smooth head with a teasing touch. Knowing that the servants were there purely for their pleasure made her bold and she stroked her fingertips over his soft, leathery balls, which were devoid of fur as they would have been for his four-legged kind. Rolling the sensitive orbs between fingers and thumb, Edith moaned softly and took his cock into her mouth, sinking down until her moist nose bumped into his lower abdomen, bottoming out.

Knowing that she was being watched brought shivers to her body and she tried not to think too much over who was watching her, imagining that it was solely the males in the room with her. It would become easier in time, she was confident of that, but she had old habits to nullify before being truly free. She would not have her daughters restricted as she had been. Resting her paws on the ibex's thighs, she held on to his muscled legs as she bobbed her muzzle. His hips rocked oh so gently, matching her rhythm, and her heart sang as he stroked his fingers through her hair, the petting, soothing touch both comforting and inexplicably arousing. It had to be all the nerve endings there – so sensitive – that had to be it.

Edith pulled back off his length, licking her lips. Clouded with arousal, her head was a fog of lust and fantasy. It was a shame they were not in a more comfortable room. She imagined sprawling across a mess of sleeping mats and cushions, letting the ibex fuck her to climax after climax, each leaving her a trembling, whimpering mess until she blacked out from pleasure. Looking up at him with a coy smile she had not thought to use since long before she had been wed to Lot, Edith ran her tongue around his cock tip, too innocent for her own good. The ibex's paws curled into fists and relaxed again as he panted heavily, begging her with his baby blue eyes even while he enjoyed every second of her attention. Edith could have fallen into those eyes, once upon a daydream or two.

Chancing a glance back over her shoulder, Edith winked at her daughters, amused by their expressions of mixed confusion and pride alike. Pheine blew her mother a kiss, hair mussed up so cutely that it was as if the canine had only just arisen from her bed chambers. Bringing a hind paw under her body, Edith stood up, meeting the ibex's eyes. There was little to no difference in height between them and the canine kept her paw on his cock as she looked him

over, his moans and soft whuffs sweet, sweet music to her ears. A male was the best melody she ever wished to enjoy.

“Are you good enough to fuck me?” She asked him sternly.

Her eyes demanded an answer and the ibex straightened unconsciously, shoulders pushing back proudly. He could only be confident in himself. He had been chosen.

“If you deem me to be such, my lady Edith,” he answered smoothly, the words pouring from his tongue like water in a desert. “I am skilled and I wish to pleasure your body, taste your nectar and pound your cunny until you cannot walk anymore for the swathes of ecstasy wracking your body from head to toe.”

He paused, nipping the inside of his cheek as if caught by indecision and pushed onward.

“The other servants speak very highly of you, Edith.”

“Oh?” This she had not anticipated. “And what do they say of me?”

“They say that you have embraced Sodom and that you can fuck males for hours and still crave more.”

Edith laughed aloud, her mirth echoing around the small chamber.

“Oh, is that what they say.” She smiled in a flash of white teeth. “I cannot allow my reputation to fall, in that case. To do so would be a sin indeed.”

Thamma started as Pheine turned to face the wall, placing both paws flat against it and thrusting her rump out in what could only be construed as an open invitation. The ibex grinned behind her back and took up position, holding on to her hips gently as he lined up with her cunny and thrust in to the hilt. The canine moaned and tilted her head back, arching into the ibex’s touch as he wrapped his arms around her waist and held her in a tight embrace as his hips worked like a piston, a machine of pure, godly sex.

Thamma whined, paw shamefully dropping between her legs as she watched the show. What sane fur could drag their eyes away? It was her mother and it felt wrong in her stomach, the stink of old memories creeping in to the corners of her mind. Teachers taught her to be chaste and proper, to worship and respect the lord, that sex was only to be had within the confines of marriage and only ever with one partner. She had broken that trust, that old, outdated lesson, and followed fresh teachings. Sighing lightly, she watched her mother pushing back against the ibex, his hips slapping into her rump, working the notion through in her head. If her mother enjoyed it, why could she not enjoy it too? Was that the lesson to be learned?

Her eyebrows rose in unison. It had to be! There was no other explanation. The Canaan dog could have danced around the room in joy but she had something much better in mind.

Clearing her throat, Thamma chanced a victorious grin with Pheine, relieved that the decision had, in this instance, been made for her: it was okay to fuck now.

“Well, if it’s okay by mother...” Thamma blinked. “Why should we not enjoy too?”

“Why not indeed?” Pheine giggled and waved her paw at her sister in a shooing motion. “That is what I have been telling you this whole time, sister. There is no reason to not enjoy, so please do. Take that step.”

The canine shifted her weight and whined, torn between lust and past experience for the briefest of moments. And then the wall broke. She jumped up and called the rodent to her with two crooked fingers, lips parted in a very canine smile. He came forward eagerly, skinny hairless tail sticking out straight behind him for the natural balance of his species.

Watching her sister take the first step in enjoying herself, Pheine called to the horse she had played with earlier, bouncing his cock for her own amusement.

“Your member is suitable,” she said too formally, unable to keep the amusement from her voice. “Fuck me.”

Finally, Pheine grins and affirms to her servant that the penis is suitable, then watches her mother and sister get off whilst getting fucked. In post-orgasmic bliss, Edith begins to suspect that the story told by her daughter about her calling the shots during the cave orgies is true.

*

Raguel’s visits had become a regular occurrence in Lot’s jail cell. The guards did not mind his visits, thinking him to be speaking of Lot’s sins. It was true that they went over the upcoming trial in great detail but more explicit liaisons took place long after the guards had lost interest in their conversation. Whether they truly knew what was going on or not was up for debate, but Lot did not care if they knew either way.

Side by side, the two friends sat inside the cold prison cell, shoulders touching. In the distance, the guards murmured, speaking amongst each other to stay awake through the long, freezing night. To ward off the bone-shaking chill, they had lit a fire and the flames leaped and crackled to the sky, toying with the shadows so that they danced across the sand. While their furs kept them warm, the furs within the cell could not count themselves as lucky, particularly Lot. Raguel gave the dog a woven blanket whenever they were together, though the canine was loathe to accept it, feeling that he should bear the cold as part of his punishment.

Back ramrod straight, the Canaan dog stared directly at the wall in front of him, scarred with frustrated marks from his now ragged claws. Raguel traced the outline of the canine’s muzzle with his eyes, observing his unblinking stare with gnawing concern. The canine was colder than he and it worried him. Raguel could not stand the cold and it bit into his flesh like a ravenous, wild beast whenever he visited Lot at night. It was one discomfort that he gladly bore for his friend, however, even if his concern grew night by night. Once, he had left Lot some clothes but when he had visited next they had been removed, leaving Lot with the same stained cloth that he had been wearing for days.

Need stirred in the rabbit’s belly and he shyly stroked the canine’s side, fingers tracing a patch of fur protruding through a rip in his battered tunic. Lot shifted and exhaled slowly as if falling into a death rattle.

“Not tonight, Raguel, please.”

The rabbit’s ear twitched and he tilted his head into his paw. Lot had never refused him before. Though he was yet to explore with females, Raguel enjoyed his time with Lot and craved it more and more. The only female he had eyes for was Ansha and he could not imagine seeing another lady without first having her in his arms. But his friend comforted him and he liked to think he could comfort him in return. Lot could not be executed, after all. If his story was true in all its retellings, the Canaan dog had done nothing wrong, though his daughters were another case entirely. Raguel doubted that they would ever be tried in court for what they had instigated, the pain and suffering they had caused.

Lifting his paw higher, Raguel rested it upon the canine’s shoulder, smoothing down the orange-tan fur.

“What is on your mind, friend?” He had the good grace to appear abashed. “It is unlike you to turn me away.”

“Many things.” Lot sighed again. “I do not wish to place my burdens upon your shoulders, Raguel. It is too much for me to ask you to bear.”

“You are not asking anything of me that I am not already offering,” Raguel assured him swiftly. “Please, tell me, Lot. I may be able to help. I can at least listen.”

The canine looked up at the ceiling, holding his breath so that his clothing stretched tight across his chest until he released the breath. There was too much that needed to be said and so little time that he had the inclination to spoil.

“Our relationship...as friends and more.” Lot shook his head. “It has deeper roots than I have previously explained. Considering the trial is upcoming, though lord knows when, you may need to know.”

Raguel’s gaze was steady and he squeezed the canine’s shoulder in a quick show of support. He would be by Lot’s side whatever happened, but he dared not vocalise it for fear of the promise becoming less so in vocalisation.

“Tell me.”

*

Lot fled as swiftly as his short legs could carry him, paws pounding the sand. The fires of hell scorched his heels and his ears lay pinned flat to his skull, eyes showing off a rim of white. To his rear, another canine snarled, coming up behind in hot pursuit of his younger charge. Every breath scraped through Lot’s lungs like a brand, searing the memory of fear into his mind. He could not stop, he would not stop. No good would come if he allowed himself to falter now. He must have faith in the lord, faith in himself and faith in blessed good fortune, whether it was to be granted or not.

But it was useless: a ten year old could not out run a fit, strong Canaan dog. He had no hope and yet he set his jaw, leaning forward into the motion as he willed his burning legs to give

him just a little more speed, just enough to make good his escape. He ran past the last house on the estate, not caring if the occupants saw him – he was sure they had seen it all before. It was a regular occurrence, after all, and not all that uncommon for a youngster to flee an older male as if he had stolen the last sweet meat from the kitchen.

The rock came out of nowhere and caught his hind paw, sending the young dog tumbling to the dirt in a bodily thump, rolling over once. He wheezed, breath knocked from his lungs, and then his father was upon him. Breathing heavily, Haran met his son's eyes with his sharp blue pair and grasped his collar, lifting him from the floor as easily as a servant may pick up a sack of flour. The young canine squirmed but did not protest otherwise, knowing that it was futile. Lifting his paws like a feral dog caught by the scruff, Lot made himself as small and as repentant as was physically possible. He swallowed hard and looked down, the pressure on his neck from the twisted collar increasing by the second.

He did not expect the fist that sank into his abdomen. The dog twisted in pain, eyes watering. He had only been cuffed about the head before and that was bad enough! Yet he had done wrong... Did he deserve the punishment? Lot shook his head as if trying to shake an answer from it. Lot struggled to regain his breath, but before he had opportunity to do so, another blow caught him about the head, making his ears ring like they had that time he had been unwell with fever.

Breath was slow to return and Haran displayed odd patience for the moment, storm seething below the surface. His kindness, if it could be called such, in allowing his son to catch his breath was ill-advised, however, and as soon as air returned to Lot's lungs he screamed at the top of his voice, hurt echoing across the fields.

"Quiet!" Haran growled, fury rumbling in his throat. "You have done enough! Have you no shame? Do you not repent for the sins you have committed?"

Lot trembled, took a deep breath and screamed again, only to be cut off by his father's free paw closing around his throat like a vice. Jerking his small, lean body back and forth, Lot twisted as if to wrench himself free, finding the hold upon him too great only after pain ricocheted through his throat. He panicked, clawing at his father and whimpering without air all the apologies and requests for forgiveness he could utter, eyes wide and pleading with innocence. The older canine only released Lot when his eyes bulged, paws scrabbling wildly through thin air as the lack of oxygen led his body to fail, vision slipping slowly into misty grey. Gasping, Lot shook, sobs interrupted much needed breath, and did not scream again.

"Haran?" An alarmed voice caught their attention. "What has possessed you? Release him immediately!"

Still holding his son aloft, the Canaan dog turned slowly to look at the approaching canine. He was a Canaan dog like himself but pure white, muscled so that they could have otherwise been the spitting images of one another. Haran licked his lips, tracing his tongue across his pointed canines. A bird sang somewhere across the fields, warbling song standing out in stark contrast to the conflict taking place beneath the blasting noonday sun.

"That I cannot do, brother."

The Canaan dog dropped his son on the ground and folded his arms across his broad, muscled

chest, which rose and fell noticeably in restrained anger. Perhaps it was just as well that his brother had emerged from his home to raise a paw within the conflict. He would not go as far as he had initially planned, if he had another of his family to keep his paw in check.

Yet the sin was great.

“Are you well?” The white canine demanded of Lot, half-extending a paw to help the young dog to his paws.

Shrinking back on the ground, Lot kicked himself away, bare hind paws scuffing through the dirt. He held one paw over his throat as if he feared he would be choked again, breath coming in short, sharp gasps as if he could not get enough air into his lungs after the incident. The white Canaan dog turned on Lot with a steely edge to his gaze, one paw balling up into a fist.

“What is the meaning of this?” He demanded. “Why is there commotion? What has he done this time? And what in the Lord’s good will drove you to *choke* the pup?”

Kicking dirt in the direction of his son, Haran sighed, slumping forward. It was as if the weight of the world had suddenly been placed upon his shoulders – an unwelcome burden. He already had enough to deal with. And now the pup engaging in such acts? It did not bear thinking about. He was not unmarried.

“I caught him with *her* daughter.”

Lot jerked his head to the left, indicating the land to the south of his, sun beating overhead. He would not say her name, that foul female with a razor tongue. She did not know her place.

“What do you mean?” The white canine asked more cautiously, not wanting to believe in the realisation he was slowly coming to.

“Lot was with her daughter.”

Haran quieted his voice, glancing left and right for observers, though he could see far across the fields and there were only slaves and servants working.

“I found him in one of the outbuildings with the oldest one.” Haran wrinkled his muzzle. “A fennec fox at least will not cause our family trouble down the line, but it is a sin nonetheless. He should not have been with the female at his stage in life. It is not right.”

The white canine shook his head, jaw slightly agape. He could not believe that the kind little pup could be capable of such debauchery. That was reserved between those joined before God. It could not happen otherwise and between two different species was another taboo in itself. How could one mate if they did not intend to produce offspring from the coupling? It was beyond the purposes of producing young and further than he was willing to forgive the fault of the young.

Lot sniffled.

“She asked me to do it,” he mumbled, eyes fixed upon the ground. “She...she’s the one that made me do it. I did not wish to...but she insisted. She said that it was time that I learned. I did not know anything.”

Lot fell quiet, a sob catching in his throat. He watched a beetle crawl through the dirt and disappear into the sparse, wiry grass. Haran unfolded his arms, arms hanging loosely at his sides, though his paws locked into tight fists.

“What did you say?”

Haran’s eyes narrowed and Lot shuddered, quailing beneath the bitter glare he felt upon his skin. He had to try. He had to give his side. He could not be completely in the wrong. He was sorry.

“I –”

As Lot tried to continue his defence, a solid kick landing in his ribcage, silencing him as pain raced. Through his daze of fear and overheating, he hoped that the strike had not broken any ribs. The most he could hope for right then was any lessening of the pain, whatever that entailed in the Lord’s forgiveness. He knew what he had done was against scripture, was against the Lord’s word, but he could not explain why it had felt right in his heart.

Until he was caught.

Abraham shook his head, finding no argument in the matter. It was how the world was and they could not anger the Lord. His lambs should never go against his will and that was something that Lot needed to learn. And swiftly too. He extended his paw to Haran, patting his shoulder before dropping his paw to his side, the enormity of Lot’s sin swallowing him. Lot did not know but Lot would learn.

“Your actions will appease the Lord,” Abraham sighed, shoulders slumping forward. “His wish is to keep his sheep pure, clean of sexual impropriety. This must be corrected.”

Haran straightened, tail twitching as he rounded on Lot, fist drawn back as if to swing another punch at the downed pup.

“See what your uncle says?” Haran snarled, lips curling back from his teeth. “I’m doing this for your own good.”

“One day, you will thank me for all I have done for you, Lot.”

Abraham looked away, refusing to watch as his brother raised his fist to Lot again. Even if it was right, he would not watch. Even if it was the Lord’s will, he would not watch. Yet Lot would learn.

The pup yelped as the paw sank into his stomach for the umpteenth time and Abraham only walked away when Lot’s sobbing became too much for even him to bear. The sun beat down and he closed his ears to the sniffles, hardening his heart as he opened it to the Lord, his word and wisdom.

Later, Lot would shun marriage and contact with females, dreading the same treatment. He had not done anything wrong, but one could only associate the liaison and all it entailed with pain. His body ached for days afterward and the lesson was one that sunk deep into his psyche. Curiously, Haran never truly understood why Lot was so indifferent to females, when he did come of age. But he found the perfect match for him in Edith. With her mother being from the sex trade, she would ensure the continuation of Haran's line with her lusty ways. Wide hips too, she had: good for birthing. Yet Lot would still not be interested for one very simple reason.

Sex and the pleasure that came with it was not worth a beating.